SSC CGL — English Master Vocabulary Table

737 words + **75 idioms** — merged from all newspaper & journal vocabulary files into one alphabetical table. Word → part of speech → meaning → synonyms → antonyms → example.

Sources — Journal/International: 291 · Newspaper (1-Year): 339 · Newspaper (Starter): 107 · antonyms matched for 360 words from the thesaurus file.

How to use: Learn a few words a day. Read the **meaning**, the synonyms (easy words for it) and the antonyms (opposites), then read the *example* aloud — that is where the meaning sticks. The table is alphabetical so you can find and revise any word fast.

A · Master Vocabulary (737 words)

WORD	POS	MEANING	SYNONYMS (easy words)	ANTONYMS (opposites)	EXAMPLE	SOURCE
A						
a priori	*adjective*	based on reasoning or theory rather than on actual experience	in theory, beforehand, from reasoning		*There is no a priori reason to assume the trend will continue*	Journal
Abate	*verb*	to become less strong; to reduce	lessen, drop, ease	increase, grow, rise, strengthen, intensify, escalate	*The government waited for the monsoon fury to abate before reopening the flooded highways*	News·Y
Abet	*verb*	to help someone do something wrong	help, support, assist	stop, prevent, oppose, hinder, discourage, obstruct, thwart	*The officials were accused of helping and abetting the illegal sand mining along the river*	News·Y
Abide	*verb*	to accept and follow a rule or decision	follow, obey, accept	break, ignore, disobey, defy, violate, flout	*The court made it clear that all parties must abide by its order, irrespective of their political differences*	News·Y
Abound	*verb*	to exist in large numbers; to be plenty	fill, swarm, overflow	lack, want, be scarce, be rare, be few, fall short	*Rumours abound in the city ahead of the crucial state elections next month*	News·Y
Abrogate	*verb*	to officially cancel a law or agreement	cancel, end, scrap	keep, allow, support, approve, uphold, enforce, establish, ratify	*The state cannot abrogate fundamental rights even during an emergency*	News·Y
Abrupt	*adjective*	sudden and unexpected	sudden, quick, sharp	slow, smooth, gradual, gentle, expected, leisurely	*The minister's abrupt resignation took even his own party by surprise*	News·Y
Accede	*verb*	To agree to a demand after pressure; also to formally join a treaty or take high office	agree, accept, join		*The government acceded to the rebels' demands for a power-sharing deal*	Journal
Acclaim	*noun*	strong public praise	praise, applause, honour	blame, criticism, disapproval, scorn, condemnation, censure	*The film won wide acclaim for its honest portrayal of rural life*	News·Y
Accord	*noun*	a formal agreement between countries or sides	agreement, deal, pact		*The peace accord ended thirty years of armed conflict*	Journal
Accountability	*noun*	being answerable for your actions, having to explain and take blame	answerability, responsibility		*The report demanded greater accountability from public officials who had mismanaged the relief funds*	Journal
Acrimony	*noun*	bitter, angry feelings between people	bitterness		*The talks ended in acrimony with no deal*	News·S

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Acumen	*noun*	the skill to think and judge quickly and well	sharpness, skill, sense	foolishness, dullness, stupidity, ignorance, naivety, obtuseness	*Her political acumen helped the party win seats even in difficult constituencies*	News·Y
Acute	*adjective*	very serious or severe	severe, sharp, serious	mild, light, slight, gentle, minor, chronic	*The city is facing an acute shortage of drinking water this summer*	News·Y
ad hoc	*adjective*	made or done only for one purpose, right now, not planned in advance	for-this-only, on-the-spot, unplanned		*The UN set up an ad hoc committee to handle the sudden refugee crisis*	Journal
Adaptation	*noun*	changing in order to cope with new conditions	adjustment, change, coping		*Coastal cities are spending billions on adaptation measures such as sea walls against rising tides*	Journal
Adhere	*verb*	to stick to or strictly follow a rule	stick, follow, keep to	break, ignore, leave, abandon, disobey, separate, detach	*Banks have been told to adhere to the new lending norms issued by the Reserve Bank of India*	News·Y
Adjacent	*adjective*	lying next to something	next to, nearby, neighbouring		*Flooding affected the river and all adjacent farmland*	Journal
Adverse	*adjective*	harmful or unfavourable	bad, harmful, negative	good, helpful, positive, favourable, beneficial, advantageous	*Experts warned of the adverse effects of rising prices on poor families*	News·Y
Advocate	*verb*	to publicly support an idea or cause	support, back, recommend	oppose, resist, attack, reject, discourage, denounce	*Several economists advocate greater spending on health and education*	News·Y
Affluent	*adjective*	having a lot of money; rich	rich, wealthy, well-off	poor, needy, broke, penniless, deprived, impoverished, destitute	*The new tax mainly affects affluent households living in the metro cities*	News·Y
Affront	*noun*	a rude act or insult that hurts pride	insult, offence, slight	compliment, praise, honour, respect, courtesy, flattery	*The minister's remark was seen as an affront to the dignity of the farming community*	News·Y
Aggregate	*adjective*	combined or added together into one total	total, combined, whole		*The aggregate effect of small savings across millions of homes was huge*	Journal
Albeit	*conjunction*	although; even though	though, even if, while		*Growth returned in the third quarter, albeit at a slower pace than hoped*	Journal
Allay	*verb*	to reduce someone's fear or worry	calm, ease		*The government tried to allay public fears about the vaccine*	News·S
Allege	*verb*	to say someone did something wrong, without proof yet	claim, accuse		*The report alleges that the company hid its losses*	News·S
Alleviate	*verb*	to make a problem or pain less severe	reduce, ease, lessen	worsen, increase, add to, intensify, aggravate, exacerbate	*The relief package is meant to alleviate the suffering of farmers hit by the floods*	News·Y
Allocate	*verb*	to give out money or resources for a particular purpose	give, share out, set aside		*Parliament allocated two billion dollars to renewable energy in the new budget*	Journal
Ambiguous	*adjective*	unclear, having more than one meaning	confusing, unclear		*The law's ambiguous wording has confused officials*	News·S

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Ambivalent	*adjective*	having mixed feelings; pulled both ways	unsure, of two minds, mixed		*Voters appear deeply ambivalent about the reforms, supporting the goal but fearing the cost*	Journal
Amend	*verb*	to officially change or correct a law or text	change, fix, correct	keep, leave, worsen, spoil, corrupt	*Parliament is expected to amend the law to close the loophole*	News·Y
Ample	*adjective*	more than enough; plenty	enough, plenty, large	little, small, not enough, lacking, scarce, insufficient, meagre	*The government claims it has ample reserves of food grains to manage any crisis*	News·Y
Analyse	*verb*	to study something carefully to understand its parts and meaning	study, examine, break down		*Scientists analysed blood samples from thousands of patients to find the pattern*	Journal
Annex	*verb*	to take control of and add another's territory to your own	take over, seize, add		*The state moved to annex the disputed valley, drawing global condemnation*	Journal
Annexation	*noun*	when one country takes over and adds another's land to its own by force	takeover, seizing land, grabbing		*Most UN members refused to recognise the annexation of the peninsula in 2014*	Journal
Annihilate	*verb*	to destroy something completely	wipe out, destroy, crush		*Commanders warned that nuclear weapons could annihilate entire cities*	Journal
Annul	*verb*	To officially cancel a law, contract, or result so it no longer counts	cancel, void, scrap		*The court annulled the election results after evidence of widespread fraud*	Journal
Anomaly	*noun*	something that is unusual and does not fit the pattern	oddity, exception, irregularity		*The satellite recorded a temperature anomaly far above the seasonal norm*	Journal
Antithesis	*noun*	the exact opposite	opposite		*His calm style was the antithesis of his rival's*	News·S
Approximate	*adjective*	close to but not exactly correct	rough, near, close		*The report gave an approximate figure for global carbon emissions*	Journal
Arbitrate	*verb*	To act as a neutral judge to settle a dispute between two sides	judge, settle, referee		*The UN agreed to arbitrate the border dispute between the two nations*	Journal
Arguably	*adverb*	it can be reasonably claimed; one could make a good case for it	possibly, you could say, perhaps		*This is arguably the most important climate report published in the last decade*	Journal
Arrears	*noun*	money owed that should have been paid earlier	overdue payments, unpaid dues, backlog		*Millions of households fell into arrears on rent as living costs spiralled*	Journal
Ascendancy	*noun*	A position of growing power, control, or dominance over others	rise, power, dominance		*The party's ascendancy reshaped the country's foreign policy for a decade*	Journal
Ascertain	*verb*	to find out something for certain	find out, confirm, check		*Inspectors worked to ascertain the cause of the collapse*	Journal
Assess	*verb*	to judge the value, size, or quality of something	judge, check, rate		*The World Bank assessed the damage from the floods at over two billion dollars*	Journal
Asylum	*noun*	protection given by a country to someone fleeing danger	refuge, safety, shelter		*The activist sought asylum at a foreign embassy after the crackdown*	Journal
Attainable	*adjective*	able to be achieved	reachable, doable, achievable		*The UN said the target is attainable with sustained funding*	Journal

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Attenuate	*verb*	to make weaker or smaller	weaken, reduce, lessen		*The mask did not stop infection entirely but attenuated the spread of the virus*	Journal
Attribute	*verb*	to say something is caused by a particular thing	credit, blame, link		*The study attributes the fall in crime to better street lighting rather than policing*	Journal
Audacious	*adjective*	very bold and daring, sometimes shockingly so	bold, daring, fearless	timid, shy, careful, fearful, cautious, cowardly, meek	*The startup's audacious plan to electrify every village bus fleet drew both praise and doubt*	News·Y
Austerity	*noun*	strict saving / cutting spending	cost-cutting		*The government announced austerity measures to control the deficit*	News·S
Autocracy	*noun*	rule by one person or group with total, unchecked power	one-man rule, dictatorship		*The index warned that several democracies were sliding quietly toward autocracy as leaders weakened the courts*	Journal
Autonomy	*noun*	the right of a region to govern its own affairs	self-rule, independence, freedom		*The province was promised greater autonomy in return for laying down arms*	Journal
Average	*noun*	the middle or typical amount, found by adding values and dividing	typical, middle, mean		*On average, patients recovered two days faster with the new treatment*	Journal
Avert	*verb*	to stop something bad from happening	prevent, stop, avoid	cause, allow, invite, bring on, provoke, trigger	*Timely talks between the two sides helped avert a major strike*	News·Y
B						
Backbone	*noun*	the most important supporting part of something	support, base, main part	weakness, cowardice, timidity	*Small farmers remain the backbone of the country's rural economy*	News·Y
Backlash	*noun*	a strong, angry reaction from many people against something	anger, protest, reaction	support, praise, approval, acceptance, welcome, endorsement	*The sudden hike in toll charges triggered a sharp backlash from commuters across the highway*	News·Y
Bailout	*noun*	emergency money given to rescue a failing bank, firm or country	rescue, lifeline, financial rescue		*The government approved a massive bailout to stop the airline from going under*	Journal
Bane	*noun*	a cause of great trouble or ruin	curse, ruin, problem	blessing, joy, help, comfort, boon, delight	*Unchecked corruption remains the bane of public service delivery in many districts*	News·Y
Baseline	*noun*	a starting level used to measure later change	starting point, base, level		*Doctors recorded each patient's baseline weight before the diet began*	Journal
Belated	*adjective*	coming later than it should have	late, delayed, overdue	early, on-time, prompt, timely, punctual	*The government's belated response to the drought left many farmers without timely aid*	News·Y
Belie	*verb*	to give a false idea; to hide the truth	hide, mask, disguise	show, reveal, prove, confirm, support, demonstrate	*The calm figures in the report belie the deep distress in rural households*	News·Y
Belligerent	*adjective*	acting in an aggressive, war-ready way	hostile, aggressive, fighting		*The minister's belligerent speech raised fears of a wider conflict*	Journal
Benchmark	*noun*	a standard level used to measure or compare performance	standard, marker, reference point		*The fund failed to beat its benchmark index for the third year running*	Journal

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Benign	*adjective*	gentle and harmless; not dangerous	kind, gentle, harmless	harmful, cruel, dangerous, hostile, malignant, malevolent	*What looked like a benign policy change quietly raised the tax burden on small traders*	News·Y
Bid	*noun*	an attempt or effort to do something	attempt, try, effort		*In a bid to reduce pollution, the city banned old diesel vehicles*	News·Y
Blame	*verb/noun*	to say someone is responsible for something bad	fault, accuse, hold responsible	praise, thank, excuse, forgive, clear, absolve, exonerate, vindicate	*Opposition leaders were quick to blame the government for the power cuts*	News·Y
Bleak	*adjective*	without hope; looking very bad for the future	hopeless, dark, gloomy	bright, hopeful, cheerful, promising, encouraging, rosy	*With factories shutting down, the job outlook for young graduates looks increasingly bleak*	News·Y
Blockade	*noun*	Sealing off a place to stop goods or people from entering or leaving	blocking, sealing off, siege		*The naval blockade prevented food and medicine from reaching the port city*	Journal
Bolster	*verb*	to strengthen or support	strengthen, boost	weaken, lessen, undermine, diminish, undercut	*New troops were sent to bolster the border force*	News·S
bona fide	*adjective*	genuine; real and sincere, not fake	genuine, real, honest		*Only bona fide refugees qualify for the protection scheme*	Journal
Boost	*verb/noun*	to increase or improve	help, lift		*The new policy aims to boost exports*	News·S
Breach	*noun*	the breaking of a rule, law, or promise	break, violation, breaking	obey, follow, keep, observe, comply, adhere, uphold	*The data leak was described as a serious breach of citizens' privacy*	News·Y
Breed	*verb*	to cause something, usually something bad, to develop	cause, create, produce	stop, prevent, suppress, halt, stifle	*Delays in justice only breed anger and distrust among ordinary citizens*	News·Y
Brinkmanship	*noun*	pushing a dangerous situation to the edge to win	risky pressure tactics		*The nuclear brinkmanship alarmed the world*	News·S
Brunt	*noun*	the worst part or main force of something bad	worst part, full force, blow		*Farmers in the region bore the brunt of the failed monsoon this year*	News·Y
Buoyant	*adjective*	cheerful and confident; rising and strong	cheerful, hopeful, lively	sad, low, gloomy, depressed, downcast, dejected, despondent	*Festive sales kept the market buoyant despite warnings of a global slowdown*	News·Y
C						
Candid	*adjective*	honest and direct in speaking	honest, frank, open	dishonest, secretive, guarded, evasive, insincere, deceptive	*In a candid interview, the chief minister admitted the policy had failed*	News·Y
Capacity	*noun*	the ability or resources to do something	ability, power, room		*The programme aims to build local capacity so communities can manage their own water supply*	Journal
Capitulate	*verb*	to give up / surrender	surrender		*The company refused to capitulate to the demands*	News·S

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Causation	*noun*	the relationship where one thing directly causes another	cause, link, reason		*Correlation does not prove causation, the authors cautioned*	Journal
Caveat	*noun*	a warning or condition to keep in mind	warning, condition		*The report comes with one caveat: the data is incomplete*	News·S
Ceasefire	*noun*	an agreement to stop fighting, at least for a while	truce, stop fighting, pause		*A fragile ceasefire allowed aid trucks to reach the besieged city*	Journal
Censure	*verb*	to blame or criticise strongly and officially	blame, scold, condemn	praise, approve, applaud, support, commend, laud	*The court did not hesitate to censure the agency for its careless handling of evidence*	News·Y
Chicanery	*noun*	clever trickery to deceive	trickery, cheating		*Voters were warned against electoral chicanery*	News·S
Cite	*verb*	to mention something as a reason or proof	mention, quote, point to		*The court cited the right to privacy while striking down the surveillance order*	News·Y
Clandestine	*adjective*	done secretly, especially something illegal or sneaky	secret, hidden, undercover		*Investigators uncovered a clandestine programme to enrich uranium*	Journal
Cleave	*verb*	to split or divide sharply	split, divide, cut	join, unite, stick, connect, merge, bond, fuse	*The new bill threatens to cleave the alliance along religious and regional lines*	News·Y
Clientelism	*noun*	trading public favours, jobs or money for political support and votes	favour-trading, vote-buying		*Analysts blamed entrenched clientelism for the way state contracts flowed only to loyal supporters*	Journal
Clout	*noun*	power or influence to affect decisions	power, influence, weight	weakness, powerlessness, helplessness	*The trade body still carries enormous clout in shaping export policy*	News·Y
Coalesce	*verb*	to come together and form one group or whole	unite, join, merge	split, separate, divide, scatter, disperse, fragment, disintegrate	*Several small farmer unions coalesced into a single body to press their demands*	News·Y
Coalition	*noun*	a group of parties joining together	alliance, group		*The state is ruled by a three-party coalition*	News·S
Coerce	*verb*	to force someone to do something by threat	force, pressure, push	allow, persuade, request, encourage, coax	*The report alleged that villagers were coerced into selling their land*	News·Y
Coffer	*noun*	A store of money or funds belonging to a government or organisation	treasury, funds, money store		*Falling oil prices drained the kingdom's once-overflowing coffers*	Journal
Cogent	*adjective*	clear, logical and convincing	strong, clear, convincing		*The defence presented a cogent argument that the evidence had been gathered unlawfully*	Journal
Coherent	*adjective*	clear, logical, and easy to understand	clear, logical, sensible	confusing, unclear, muddled, illogical, disjointed, incoherent, rambling	*The government has yet to present a coherent strategy to tackle rising unemployment*	News·Y
Cohesive	*adjective*	well united and working closely together	united, joined, together	divided, loose, scattered, disconnected, fragmented, disjointed, disunited	*A cohesive opposition could pose a real challenge to the ruling party in the next election*	News·Y
Collateral	*noun*	something valuable promised to a lender in case a loan is not repaid	security, pledge, backing		*Borrowers were forced to put up property as collateral for the emergency loans*	Journal

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Commodity	*noun*	a basic traded good like oil, gold, wheat or metal	raw good, traded item, basic product		*Commodity prices soared as the war disrupted supplies of wheat and crude oil*	Journal
Compatible	*adjective*	able to exist or work well together	matching, suited, fitting	clashing, opposed, conflicting, mismatched, incompatible, contradictory	*The reforms must be compatible with the country's wider development goals*	News·Y
Compel	*verb*	to force someone to do something	force, push, make	allow, free, release, permit, persuade	*Rising fuel prices have compelled many middle-class families to cut back on travel*	News·Y
Compelling	*adjective*	very convincing; making you want to pay attention	strong, convincing, powerful	boring, weak, dull, unconvincing, uninteresting, feeble	*The economist made a compelling case for raising taxes on the super-rich*	News·Y
Complacent	*adjective*	too satisfied so that you stop trying	smug, lazy, careless	worried, alert, careful, concerned, dissatisfied, vigilant, discontented	*Health officials cannot afford to be complacent even as new cases begin to fall*	News·Y
Compliance	*noun*	the act of obeying a rule or law	obeying, following, agreement	disobedience, refusal, resistance, defiance, violation, noncompliance, rebellion, insubordination	*Many factories were shut down for non-compliance with the new pollution norms*	News·Y
Complicit	*adjective*	taking part in or helping with something wrong	involved, guilty, helping	innocent, blameless, uninvolved, guiltless, unconnected	*The report suggests that some officials were complicit in covering up the scam*	News·Y
Compound	*verb*	to make a bad situation even worse	worsen, add to, increase	ease, lessen, reduce, lighten, alleviate, mitigate	*Heavy rains compounded the misery of flood-hit villages already short of food*	News·Y
Comprehensive	*adjective*	complete and covering everything	complete, full, thorough	incomplete, partial, limited, narrow, selective, restricted	*The committee called for a comprehensive review of the country's labour laws*	News·Y
Comprise	*verb*	to be made up of parts	consist of, contain, include		*The survey comprises responses from forty countries*	Journal
Compromise	*noun/verb*	a deal where each side gives up something; or to weaken something	deal, middle ground, weaken	disagreement, dispute, stalemate, deadlock, discord	*Both parties must compromise if the long-running border talks are to succeed*	News·Y
Concede	*verb*	to admit something is true or to give in	admit, accept, give in	deny, refuse, reject, dispute, contest, resist, contradict	*The chief minister finally conceded that the relief work had been delayed*	News·Y
Conceivably	*adverb*	it is possible to imagine; it could possibly happen	possibly, maybe, it could be		*The drug could conceivably be repurposed to treat other inflammatory diseases*	Journal
Concurrent	*adjective*	happening at the same time	at once, parallel, simultaneous		*The country faced concurrent crises of drought and debt*	Journal
Confound	*verb*	to confuse results by mixing in a hidden cause	confuse, muddle, mislead		*Smoking may confound the link between coffee and heart disease*	Journal
Consistent	*adjective*	staying the same; not changing from test to test	steady, even, dependable		*The results were consistent across all three independent laboratories*	Journal
Constituency	*noun*	the group of voters in an area, or the people a leader represents	voter base, district, supporters		*The minister risked alienating her rural constituency by backing the unpopular land reform*	Journal

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Contend	*verb*	to argue or claim that something is true; to compete	argue, claim, compete	agree, accept, concede, yield, retreat	*Critics contend that the new policy favours large corporations over small traders*	News·Y
Contentious	*adjective*	causing a lot of disagreement	disputed, controversial	agreed, calm, peaceful, friendly, uncontroversial, harmonious, undisputed	*The contentious bill was sent back for review*	News·S
Contiguous	*adjective*	touching or next to each other	touching, neighbouring, joined		*The disease spread quickly across contiguous districts*	Journal
Contingent	*adjective*	depending on something else happening first	depending on, based on, conditional		*Further funding is contingent on the government meeting its reform targets*	Journal
Contraction	*noun*	a shrinking of the economy or output	shrinking, drop, decline		*GDP recorded its steepest contraction in decades as lockdowns shut down trade*	Journal
Control	*noun*	a group in a test that gets no treatment, used to compare results	comparison group, baseline		*Compared with the control group, the treated patients showed clear improvement*	Journal
Convene	*verb*	to call people together for a meeting	gather, meet, call together	end, close, dismiss, disperse, adjourn, disband, dissolve	*The Speaker convened an emergency session of Parliament to discuss the flood crisis*	News·Y
Converge	*verb*	to come together from different directions to one point	meet, join, come together	separate, spread, scatter, part, diverge, disperse	*Thousands of protesters converged on the state capital to demand higher wages*	News·Y
Converse	*noun*	the opposite of a statement; the reverse	opposite, reverse, flip side		*The data show that wealth improves health, but the converse — that good health builds wealth — also holds*	Journal
Co-opt	*verb*	to win someone over and absorb them so they stop opposing you	win over, absorb, take in		*The ruling party tried to co-opt the protest leaders by offering them seats in government*	Journal
Corollary	*noun*	a result or fact that naturally follows from something already proven	natural result, follow-on, knock-on point		*A corollary of rising sea levels is the loss of low-lying farmland*	Journal
Correlate	*verb*	to have a connection where things change together	link, match, relate		*Higher pollution levels correlated strongly with rising rates of asthma*	Journal
Correlation	*noun*	a link where two things change together (when one goes up, the other goes up or down)	link, connection, relationship		*The paper found a strong correlation between air pollution and hospital visits for asthma*	Journal
Corroborate	*verb*	to give extra evidence that supports an idea or claim	confirm, back up, prove		*Independent satellite data corroborate the team's finding that the glacier is melting faster than predicted*	Journal
Coup	*noun*	a sudden, often violent, seizure of government power	takeover, overthrow, power grab		*The military staged a coup and detained the elected leaders overnight*	Journal
Covenant	*noun*	A formal, often binding agreement or promise between parties	agreement, promise, pact		*The UN covenant commits signatory states to protect basic human rights*	Journal
Credible	*adjective*	able to be believed or trusted	believable, trusted, reliable	unbelievable, false, doubtful, unreliable, untrustworthy,	*Without credible evidence, the police could not file a charge sheet against the accused*	News·Y

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				implausible, dubious, incredible		
Creditor	*noun*	a person or institution that is owed money	lender, money-owner, the one owed		*Creditors agreed to restructure the loans to avoid pushing the firm into collapse*	Journal
Culminate	*verb*	to end or reach a final result after a long process	end, finish, result in	start, begin, originate, commence, initiate	*Months of farmer protests culminated in a meeting between the union leaders and the agriculture minister*	News·Y
Culpable	*adjective*	deserving blame for a wrong	guilty, responsible, at fault	innocent, blameless, guiltless, faultless, exonerated	*The inquiry held three officials culpable for the bridge collapse*	News·Y
Cumbersome	*adjective*	slow, heavy, and difficult to manage	clumsy, heavy, difficult	easy, light, simple, handy, manageable, convenient, compact	*Businesses complain that the cumbersome approval process discourages new investment*	News·Y
Cumulative	*adjective*	increasing by being added together step by step	growing, adding up, total		*The cumulative effect of small yearly emissions has been a sharp rise in sea levels*	Journal
Curb	*verb*	to control or reduce something	limit, stop		*The government announced new rules to curb pollution in the city*	News·S
Curtail	*verb*	to cut down or reduce something	cut, shorten, limit	increase, grow, extend, expand, lengthen, prolong, enlarge	*The state moved to curtail wasteful spending ahead of the new budget*	News·Y
D						
Dampen	*verb*	to make a feeling or activity weaker	reduce, weaken, lower	boost, encourage, increase, strengthen, intensify, heighten, invigorate	*High interest rates are likely to dampen demand in the housing sector this year*	News·Y
Data	*noun*	facts, numbers, or information collected for study	facts, figures, information		*The data showed that vaccination rates rose sharply after the campaign began*	Journal
Daunt	*verb*	to make someone lose courage	scare, discourage, worry	encourage, cheer, support, inspire, embolden, hearten	*The sheer scale of the reforms did not daunt the young administrators leading the project*	News·Y
Daunting	*adjective*	seeming very difficult and a bit frightening	scary, hard, difficult	easy, simple, encouraging, reassuring, manageable, inviting	*Rebuilding the cyclone-ravaged coastline is a daunting task that will take years and crores of rupees*	News·Y
de facto	*phrase*	Latin for 'in fact'; existing in reality even if not officially	in practice, actually, in reality		*With no formal treaty, the ceasefire became the de facto policy along the border*	Journal
de jure	*adjective*	existing by law; official, on paper (the opposite of de facto)	by law, officially, legally		*De jure the regions are equal, but funding tells a different story*	Journal
Default	*noun*	failure to repay a debt as promised	non-payment, missed payment, failure to pay		*Argentina edged toward another sovereign default after talks with creditors collapsed*	Journal
Deficient	*adjective*	not having enough of something needed	lacking, short, missing	enough, full, complete, adequate, sufficient, ample,	*Rural health centres remain deficient in both doctors and basic medicines*	News·Y

WORD	POS	MEANING	SYNONYMS (easy words)	ANTONYMS (opposites)	EXAMPLE	SOURCE
				abundant		
Deficit	*noun*	when spending is more than income	shortage, gap		*India is working to reduce its fiscal deficit*	News·S
Deflation	*noun*	a general fall in prices, often a sign of a weak economy	falling prices, price drop		*Japan battled deflation for years as consumers delayed spending in hope of cheaper goods*	Journal
Deft	*adjective*	skilful and quick, done in a clever way	skilled, clever, smart	clumsy, awkward, unskilled, careless, inept, bungling	*The minister's deft handling of the crisis prevented panic from spreading in the markets*	News·Y
Defy	*verb*	to openly refuse to obey something	disobey, resist, ignore	obey, follow, accept, submit, comply, yield, surrender	*Thousands of farmers continued to defy the ban and marched towards the capital*	News·Y
Deliberate	*adjective/ verb*	done on purpose; or to think carefully before deciding	planned, intended, discuss	accidental, unplanned, unintentional, hasty, careless, impulsive, inadvertent	*The committee will deliberate for two weeks before announcing its final decision*	News·Y
Delineate	*verb*	to describe or mark out something clearly and in detail	outline, describe, draw		*The report delineates three possible pathways by which the country could reach net-zero emissions by 2050*	Journal
Demagogue	*noun*	a leader who wins support by stirring emotions, not facts	crowd-pleaser		*Critics called him a demagogue who exploited fear*	News·S
Demarcate	*verb*	to set or mark the boundaries or limits of something	mark out, set limits, divide		*The treaty sought to clearly demarcate the contested border that had triggered repeated clashes*	Journal
Demographic	*adjective*	relating to the makeup of a population (age, income, race, etc.)	population-based, group-related		*The party's defeat reflected deep demographic shifts, as younger voters abandoned its traditional base*	Journal
Dent	*noun/verb*	to damage or weaken something a little	damage, hurt, harm	strengthen, boost, improve, reinforce, bolster	*The corruption charges have made a serious dent in the party's image*	News·Y
Deplete	*verb*	to use up something until very little is left	use up, drain, empty	fill, add, increase, restore, replenish, augment	*Years of over-extraction have depleted the city's once-rich groundwater reserves*	News·Y
Deplore	*verb*	to strongly disapprove of and feel sad about	condemn, hate, regret	praise, approve, support, admire, applaud, commend, endorse	*Editorials across the country deplored the attack on journalists covering the rally*	News·Y
Deploy	*verb*	to put resources or people into action where needed	send, use, put to work		*The UN deployed emergency teams to the flood zone within forty-eight hours*	Journal
Depose	*verb*	To remove a ruler or leader from power, often by force	overthrow, remove, topple		*The general was deposed in a bloodless coup and fled abroad*	Journal
Depreciation	*noun*	a fall in the value of a currency or asset over time	drop, fall, loss of value		*The sharp depreciation of the rupee made imported oil far more expensive for Indian refiners*	Journal
Depression	*noun*	a very deep and long-lasting economic collapse, worse than a recession	severe slump, crash, deep crisis		*Economists feared the banking crisis might spiral into a full-blown depression*	Journal
Derail	*verb*	to spoil a plan or process so it cannot continue	spoil, stop, ruin	help, support, advance, continue, promote, facilitate	*Repeated walkouts by the opposition threatened to derail the entire winter session of Parliament*	News·Y

WORD	POS	MEANING	SYNONYMS (easy words)	ANTONYMS (opposites)	EXAMPLE	SOURCE
Deride	*verb*	to make fun of someone in a cruel way	mock, laugh at, insult	praise, respect, admire, honour, applaud, commend	*Critics were quick to deride the scheme as a publicity stunt with little real benefit*	News·Y
Derive	*verb*	to get or work out something from a source	get from, draw from, obtain		*The figures were derived from census records going back fifty years*	Journal
Despondent	*adjective*	feeling very low and without hope	sad, hopeless, gloomy	happy, hopeful, cheerful, joyful, optimistic, elated	*After three failed monsoons, despondent farmers across the region demanded immediate relief*	News·Y
Destitute	*adjective*	Extremely poor, lacking food, money, and the basics to live	poor, penniless, broke		*The conflict left thousands of families destitute and dependent on aid*	Journal
Detachment	*noun*	a small group of troops sent on a separate task; also being emotionally distant	unit, small force, group		*A detachment of peacekeepers was stationed along the contested border*	Journal
Deter	*verb*	to discourage someone from doing something	discourage, stop, prevent	encourage, support, push, urge, prompt, motivate	*Stricter penalties are meant to deter people from breaking traffic rules*	News·Y
Deteriorate	*verb*	to become worse	worsen		*His health deteriorated after the surgery*	News·S
Deteriorating	*adjective*	getting worse over time	worsening, falling, weakening	improving, recovering, healing, strengthening, progressing, upgrading	*The deteriorating air quality in Delhi has forced the government to shut schools for several days each winter*	News·Y
Detrimental	*adjective*	causing harm or damage	harmful, damaging, bad	helpful, good, useful, beneficial, favourable, advantageous	*Experts warn that cutting research funding would be detrimental to the country's future progress*	News·Y
Devaluation	*noun*	an official lowering of a currency's value against others	lowering, markdown, cut in value		*China's surprise devaluation of the yuan rattled global markets for several weeks*	Journal
Deviation	*noun*	how far a value moves away from the usual or expected one	difference, drift, gap		*A small deviation from the normal range was recorded in the final week*	Journal
Dialectic	*noun*	working out the truth by setting two opposing ideas against each other	debate of opposites, back-and-forth reasoning		*The essay traces the dialectic between freedom and security in modern democracies*	Journal
Diaspora	*noun*	a people scattered far from their original homeland	scattered community, migrants abroad, exiles		*The diaspora sent billions home in remittances each year*	Journal
Diffident	*adjective*	shy and lacking confidence in oneself	shy, timid, unsure	confident, bold, sure, assertive, self-assured, audacious	*A diffident response from the regulator failed to reassure jittery markets*	News·Y
Diffuse	*verb*	to spread something widely, or to calm a tense situation	spread, calm, ease	gather, collect, concentrate, focus, contain, intensify	*Quick talks between the two states helped diffuse the tension over the river-water dispute*	News·Y
Diligent	*adjective*	hard-working and careful	careful, hard-working, sincere	lazy, careless, idle, slack, negligent	*Only diligent follow-up by officials ensured the project was finished on time*	News·Y
Diminish	*verb*	to become smaller or less	shrink, lessen, reduce	grow, increase, rise, expand, enlarge, amplify, augment	*The party's influence in the southern states has steadily diminished over the past decade*	News·Y
Diminishing returns	*noun*	the point where extra effort or input gives less and less benefit	less and less gain, smaller payoff, fading benefit		*After a certain dose, the drug showed diminishing returns and no extra effect*	Journal

WORD	POS	MEANING	SYNONYMS (easy words)	ANTONYMS (opposites)	EXAMPLE	SOURCE
Diplomacy	*noun*	the work of managing relations between countries through talks, not war	talks, negotiation, foreign relations		*After months of quiet diplomacy, the two governments agreed to reopen their embassies*	Journal
Dire	*adjective*	very serious or terrible	terrible, urgent, serious	good, fine, safe, mild, pleasant, favourable	*The flood-hit districts face a dire shortage of clean drinking water and medicines*	News·Y
Discern	*verb*	to notice or understand something clearly	notice, see, judge	miss, ignore, overlook, confuse, misjudge	*It is hard to discern any real change in policy beyond the government's bold announcements*	News·Y
Discernible	*adjective*	able to be seen or noticed, if you look carefully	noticeable, visible, clear		*There was no discernible difference between the treated and untreated groups*	Journal
Discernment	*noun*	good judgement in telling things apart	good judgement, insight, care		*Reviewers praised the author's discernment in weighing the evidence*	Journal
Discord	*noun*	disagreement and lack of harmony	conflict, fighting, quarrel	peace, agreement, harmony, unity, accord, concord	*Growing discord within the alliance threatens the stability of the state government*	News·Y
Discordant	*adjective*	not in agreement; clashing	clashing, conflicting, mismatched		*The two datasets gave discordant results on rainfall trends*	Journal
Discourse	*noun*	the whole serious discussion and writing about a topic in society	public discussion, debate, the talk		*Climate change now dominates the public discourse in many wealthy nations*	Journal
Discrepancy	*noun*	a difference between two things that should match	mismatch, gap, difference	match, agreement, similarity, harmony, consistency, accordance	*Auditors flagged a serious discrepancy between the reported spending and the actual records*	News·Y
Discrete	*adjective*	separate and individually distinct	separate, distinct, apart		*Researchers identified four discrete stages in the disease's progression*	Journal
Disenfranchise	*verb*	to take away someone's right to vote or their power in society	silence, exclude, strip rights		*Critics argued that the new voter-ID law would disenfranchise millions of poor and rural citizens who lacked formal documents*	Journal
Dismal	*adjective*	very poor, gloomy and disappointing	poor, sad, bad	bright, happy, cheerful, hopeful, splendid, excellent	*The dismal performance of the manufacturing sector dragged down the quarter's growth figures*	News·Y
Disparate	*adjective*	made up of very different things that don't normally go together	different, varied, mixed		*The protest movement united disparate groups, from students to farmers, behind a single demand*	Journal
Disparity	*noun*	a big and unfair difference between two things	gap, difference, unfairness	sameness, equality, similarity, balance, parity, uniformity	*The wide income disparity between urban and rural India remains one of the nation's deepest challenges*	News·Y
Disrupt	*verb*	to interrupt and stop the normal flow of something	interrupt, break, stop	help, order, settle, organize, arrange, stabilize	*Heavy rains disrupted rail and road traffic across the western coast for two full days*	News·Y
Dissent	*noun*	strong disagreement with an official idea or decision	protest, disagreement, objection	agreement, consent, approval, acceptance, accord, assent, concurrence	*In a healthy democracy, the right to dissent must be protected rather than treated as a crime*	News·Y
Dissident	*noun*	a person who openly disagrees with and opposes the government	opponent, rebel, critic		*The jailed dissident became a global symbol of resistance against the authoritarian regime*	Journal

WORD	POS	MEANING	SYNONYMS (easy words)	ANTONYMS (opposites)	EXAMPLE	SOURCE
Divisive	*adjective*	causing people to split into hostile groups	splitting, dividing, separating	uniting, unifying, harmonious, peaceful, cohesive, conciliatory	*The leader was criticised for making divisive remarks ahead of the elections*	News·Y
Divulge	*verb*	to reveal secret information	reveal, tell, share	hide, keep, conceal, withhold, suppress	*Officials refused to divulge the names of the firms under investigation for tax fraud*	News·Y
Dormant	*adjective*	not active for now but able to become active later	sleeping, inactive, resting	awake, active, alive, lively, working, operative	*The peace deal only kept the conflict dormant; the underlying disputes were never resolved*	News·Y
Downturn	*noun*	a period when business and the economy get worse	slump, dip, slowdown		*Retailers slashed prices to survive the sharpest downturn in consumer spending in years*	Journal
Draconian	*adjective*	extremely harsh and severe (laws)	very harsh		*Activists called the new law draconian*	News·S
Drastic	*adjective*	extreme and sudden in effect	extreme, sudden, big	mild, slight, gentle, moderate, gradual, minor	*The pandemic forced state governments to take drastic steps to slow the spread of infection*	News·Y
Dubious	*adjective*	doubtful, possibly not honest or true	doubtful, shady, unsure	sure, certain, trustworthy, reliable, credible, indisputable	*The company's dubious accounting practices finally drew the attention of investigators*	News·Y
Dwarf	*verb*	to make something else look small in comparison	outsize, overshadow, beat	magnify, enlarge, exceed, surpass, amplify	*This year's defence budget dwarfs the amount set aside for public health and education combined*	News·Y
Dwell	*verb*	to keep thinking or talking about something for a long time	focus, linger, brood	forget, ignore, overlook, dismiss, disregard	*Instead of dwelling on past failures, the new policy looks ahead to long-term reform*	News·Y
Dwindle	*verb*	to slowly become smaller in amount or number	shrink, drop, fall	grow, rise, increase, expand, multiply, swell	*As water levels dwindle, several villages now depend on tankers*	News·Y
E						
Ease	*verb*	to make less severe	reduce, relax		*The bank moved to ease lending rules for small businesses*	News·S
Ebb	*verb/noun*	to slowly reduce or fade away	fade, fall, sink	grow, rise, flow, increase, surge, swell	*As the festive season ended, the buying enthusiasm in markets began to ebb*	News·Y
Egalitarian	*adjective*	believing everyone should be equal and treated the same	equal, fair, level		*The Nordic model is often praised as egalitarian, with policies designed to keep the gap between rich and poor small*	Journal
Egregious	*adjective*	extremely bad, shockingly wrong	terrible		*The audit revealed egregious misuse of public funds*	News·S
Electorate	*noun*	all the people who are allowed to vote in an election	the voters, voting public		*Pollsters struggled to read an electorate that was angrier and more unpredictable than in past cycles*	Journal
Elucidate	*verb*	to make something clear by explaining it fully	explain, clarify, clear up		*The authors elucidate the mechanism by which the drug lowers blood pressure*	Journal
Elusive	*adjective*	hard to find, catch, or achieve	hard to catch, slippery, tricky	easy, clear, obvious, reachable, attainable, accessible	*Despite years of policy reform, lasting peace in the region remains elusive*	News·Y

WORD	POS	MEANING	SYNONYMS (easy words)	ANTONYMS (opposites)	EXAMPLE	SOURCE
Emanate	*verb*	to come out from a source	come from, flow out, arise	enter, absorb, receive, take in, withdraw	*Much of the criticism appears to emanate from those who feel left out of the reforms*	News·Y
Embargo	*noun*	an official ban on trade with a country	trade ban, blockade, stop		*The arms embargo cut off the regime's supply of new weapons*	Journal
Embezzle	*verb*	To steal money that you were trusted to look after, usually at work	steal, pocket, misuse		*The minister was jailed for embezzling millions from the relief fund*	Journal
Emphatic	*adjective*	said in a strong, clear and forceful way	strong, firm, clear	weak, unsure, doubtful, hesitant, uncertain, tentative, ambiguous	*The Prime Minister gave an emphatic assurance that the scheme would not be scrapped*	News·Y
Empirical	*adjective*	based on real observation, testing, or experience - not just on ideas or guessing	tested, observed, real-world		*The study offers empirical evidence that early schooling improves later income, drawn from data on 50,000 children*	Journal
Emulate	*verb*	to copy someone because you admire them and want to do as well	copy, imitate, follow	ignore, oppose, differ, disregard	*Other states would do well to emulate Kerala's success in raising literacy levels*	News·Y
Encroach	*verb*	To slowly move into or take over land, rights, or space that is not yours	intrude, creep in, trespass		*Farms are increasingly encroaching on protected rainforest land*	Journal
Endeavour	*noun*	a serious effort to achieve something	effort, attempt, try	rest, idleness, inaction, laziness	*The campaign is a sincere endeavour to make villages free of open drains*	News·Y
Endemic	*adjective*	regularly found in a certain place or group; a constant, settled presence	always present, native, built-in		*Corruption had become endemic in the country's police force*	Journal
Endorse	*verb*	to support publicly	support, back	reject, oppose, refuse, deny, disapprove, condemn, denounce	*Several scientists endorsed the new health guidelines*	News·S
Enfranchise	*verb*	to give someone the right to vote or full citizenship rights	give the vote, empower, include		*The amendment enfranchised eighteen-year-olds, adding millions of young people to the voter rolls*	Journal
Engender	*verb*	to cause or produce a feeling or situation	cause, create, produce	stop, end, prevent, destroy, suppress, stifle	*Transparent governance can engender greater confidence among ordinary citizens*	News·Y
Entail	*verb*	to involve something as a necessary part	involve, require, need	exclude, avoid, prevent, omit, preclude	*Reforming the power sector will entail tough choices that few governments enjoy making*	News·Y
Entrench	*verb*	to fix something so firmly that it is very hard to change	fix firmly, settle, root	remove, change, uproot, dislodge, loosen, eradicate	*Decades of red tape have entrenched corruption deep within the system*	News·Y
Envoy	*noun*	an official sent by a government to represent it abroad	messenger, representative, diplomat		*A special envoy was dispatched to broker talks between the rivals*	Journal
Ephemeral	*adjective*	lasting a very short time	short-lived	lasting, permanent, long-lived, enduring, eternal, everlasting, perpetual	*Online fame is often ephemeral*	News·S
Epistemic	*adjective*	about knowledge - how we know what we know, and how sure we can be	to do with knowing, knowledge-based		*The report warns of an epistemic crisis, in which citizens can no longer agree on basic facts*	Journal

WORD	POS	MEANING	SYNONYMS (easy words)	ANTONYMS (opposites)	EXAMPLE	SOURCE
Equitable	*adjective*	fair; treating everyone in a just way	fair, just, even-handed		*The World Bank report calls for a more equitable distribution of vaccines between rich and poor nations*	Journal
Ergo	*adverb*	therefore; for that reason (sounds formal or logical)	therefore, so, thus		*Supply fell while demand rose; ergo, prices climbed*	Journal
Erode	*verb*	to slowly weaken or destroy something over time	weaken, wear away, reduce	build, strengthen, increase, reinforce, restore	*Repeated scandals have steadily eroded public trust in the institution*	News·Y
Erstwhile	*adjective*	former; from an earlier time	former, past, old	new, present, current, future, existing	*The erstwhile rivals surprised everyone by sharing the stage at the rally*	News·Y
Escalate	*verb*	to grow quickly and become more serious	grow, rise, increase	reduce, lower, drop, ease, lessen, de-escalate, diminish	*If both sides refuse to talk, a minor border dispute could escalate into a full conflict*	News·Y
Escalation	*noun*	a rise in the intensity of a conflict or dispute	rise, worsening, build-up		*Both sides warned that any further escalation could spark open war*	Journal
Esoteric	*adjective*	understood by only a few experts	specialised, obscure		*The debate turned into an esoteric discussion few followed*	News·S
Estimate	*noun*	a careful guess of an amount based on the information you have	guess, rough figure, calculation		*The IMF's latest estimate puts global growth at just under three percent this year*	Journal
Evidence	*noun*	facts or signs that show something is true	proof, facts, signs		*There is growing evidence that the new drug lowers blood pressure in older patients*	Journal
Exacerbate	*verb*	to make a bad thing worse	worsen	help, improve, ease, calm, soothe, relieve, alleviate, mitigate	*Poor planning exacerbated the flooding*	News·S
Exodus	*noun*	a large number of people leaving a place	departure, flight, outflow	arrival, entry, coming, return, influx, immigration, ingress	*The lockdown triggered a massive exodus of migrant workers from the big cities*	News·Y
Exonerate	*verb*	to officially declare not guilty	clear, free of blame	blame, accuse, charge, convict, condemn, incriminate, inculpate	*The court exonerated him of all charges*	News·S
Exorbitant	*adjective*	far too high in price or amount	costly, steep, excessive	cheap, fair, low, reasonable, modest, affordable, moderate	*Patients complained of exorbitant fees charged by private hospitals during the crisis*	News·Y
Expansion	*noun*	a period of growing economy and rising output	growth, rise, build-up		*The longest economic expansion on record finally stalled amid the pandemic*	Journal
Extrapolate	*verb*	to use known data to estimate something beyond it	predict, estimate, project		*From current trends, economists extrapolate that the debt will double within fifteen years*	Journal
F						
Facet	*noun*	one side or part of something	side, part, aspect	whole, entirety, totality	*The report examines every facet of the rural employment crisis*	News·Y

WORD	POS	MEANING	SYNONYMS (easy words)	ANTONYMS (opposites)	EXAMPLE	SOURCE
Facilitate	*verb*	to make a process easier	help, ease, assist		*The new platform facilitates data sharing between hospitals*	Journal
Factional	*adjective*	relating to small rival groups inside a larger party or movement	split, in-fighting, group-vs-group		*Factional infighting paralysed the cabinet just as the country faced its worst economic crisis in decades*	Journal
Factor	*noun*	one thing that helps cause or shape a result	cause, reason, part		*Diet and exercise were the two biggest factors linked to a longer life*	Journal
Factor in	*verb*	to include something when you make a calculation or decision	include, count, allow for		*Once you factor in rising fuel costs, the savings almost disappear*	Journal
Fallout	*noun*	the bad results that come after an event	result, effect, damage	benefit, gain, reward, advantage, upside	*The political fallout from the scandal continued to trouble the ruling party*	News·Y
Famine	*noun*	A severe, widespread shortage of food causing hunger and death	starvation, hunger, food crisis		*Aid agencies warned that drought could push the region into famine*	Journal
Feasibility	*noun*	whether something is possible and practical to do	doability, practicality, workability		*The agency commissioned a feasibility study before funding the solar plant*	Journal
Feasible	*adjective*	possible and practical to do	possible, doable, practical	impossible, unworkable, impractical, unrealistic, unachievable	*Critics doubt whether the ambitious plan is financially feasible*	News·Y
Fervent	*adjective*	having very strong, passionate feelings	strong, eager, deep	cold, calm, weak, cool, uncaring, indifferent, apathetic, dispassionate	*Activists made a fervent appeal to the government to protect the wetlands*	News·Y
Fester	*verb*	to grow worse and more harmful over time because it is ignored	rot, worsen, build up	heal, improve, get better, mend, recover, cure	*If grievances of farmers are left unaddressed, the anger will only fester and erupt later*	News·Y
Fiscal	*adjective*	relating to government spending, taxes and budgets	money-related, budget, tax		*The finance ministry tightened fiscal policy to bring the soaring deficit under control*	Journal
Fissure	*noun*	a deep crack or split, often between groups	crack, split, gap	join, bond, union, unity, link, connection, alliance	*Deep fissures within the coalition threatened to bring down the government*	News·Y
Flagrant	*adjective*	clearly and openly bad; shocking	obvious, shocking, open	hidden, secret, slight, minor, subtle, concealed, unnoticeable	*The demolition was a flagrant violation of the court's stay order*	News·Y
Flaw	*noun*	a fault or weakness that makes something not perfect	fault, weakness, defect	strength, perfection, merit, virtue	*Experts pointed out a basic flaw in the design of the new policy*	News·Y
Fledgling	*adjective/ noun*	new and not yet experienced or fully developed	new, young, beginning	old, grown, mature, experienced, established, seasoned, veteran	*The fledgling start-ups in the sector need steady policy support before they can compete with larger firms*	News·Y
Florid	*adjective*	too fancy or overly decorated in language	showy, fancy, flowery	plain, simple, bare, dull, restrained, unadorned, austere	*The minister's florid speech offered little in the way of concrete plans*	News·Y
Flounder	*verb*	to struggle and fail to make progress	struggle, fail, stumble	succeed, win, manage, thrive, prosper, flourish,	*The startup began to flounder once funding dried up and orders slowed sharply*	News·Y

WORD	POS	MEANING	SYNONYMS (easy words)	ANTONYMS (opposites)	EXAMPLE	SOURCE
				excel		
Flout	*verb*	to openly break or ignore a rule	break, ignore, defy	follow, obey, respect, honour, observe, comply	*Builders who flout safety norms must face strict penalties, the editorial argued*	News·Y
Forbearance	*noun*	the quality of being patient and self-controlled, especially when others test you	patience, calm, restraint	anger, impatience, harshness, intolerance, severity	*The Opposition praised the Speaker's forbearance during the stormy debate in Parliament*	News·Y
Forestall	*verb*	to act early to stop something from happening	prevent, stop, block	allow, permit, cause, encourage, prompt, hasten	*The bank cut rates to forestall a deeper economic downturn*	News·Y
Forge	*verb*	to build or create something strong, like a deal or bond	build, create, form	break, end, destroy, weaken, dissolve, sever	*The two nations sought to forge a closer partnership on clean energy*	News·Y
Fortuitous	*adjective*	happening by lucky chance rather than by plan	lucky, chance, unplanned	planned, intended, deliberate, designed, intentional, premeditated	*The timing of the rate cut was fortuitous, coming just as inflation began to cool*	News·Y
Foster	*verb*	to help something grow or develop	encourage, support, grow	stop, block, discourage, prevent, hinder, suppress, stifle	*The new education policy aims to foster creativity rather than rote learning*	News·Y
Fractious	*adjective*	easily angered and hard to control; quarrelsome	angry, touchy, restless	calm, gentle, peaceful, obedient, agreeable, good-natured, amiable	*Holding together a fractious alliance will test the new leadership*	News·Y
Fragile	*adjective*	easily broken or damaged; weak	weak, delicate, breakable	strong, tough, hard, sturdy, durable, robust	*The ceasefire remains fragile, and any small spark could reignite tensions*	News·Y
Framework	*noun*	a basic structure of rules or ideas used to plan something	plan, structure, system		*The Paris Agreement provides a global framework for cutting greenhouse gas emissions*	Journal
Franchise	*noun*	the right to vote in elections	the vote, voting right		*The 1928 reform finally extended the franchise to all women over twenty-one*	Journal
Fraught	*adjective*	full of problems, danger or worry	risky, tense, worried	easy, calm, safe, relaxed, untroubled, peaceful	*The border talks remained fraught with mistrust on both sides*	News·Y
Fritter	*verb*	to waste money, time or chances little by little on unimportant things	waste, squander, throw away	save, keep, use well, invest, conserve, husband	*The state must not fritter away its budget surplus on populist freebies before the polls*	News·Y
Frugal	*adjective*	careful with money, not wasteful	careful, saving, thrifty	wasteful, lavish, extravagant, spendthrift, prodigal	*In a year of slowing growth, households turned more frugal with their spending*	News·Y
Futile	*adjective*	useless because it will not work	useless, pointless, vain	useful, helpful, successful, effective, worthwhile, fruitful, productive	*Without real reform, such half-measures will prove futile, the columnist warned*	News·Y
G						
Galvanic	*adjective*	giving a sudden shock that makes people act	shocking, exciting, rousing	dull, boring, calming, soothing, uninspiring, deadening	*The verdict had a galvanic effect on activists, who took to the streets within hours*	News·Y

WORD	POS	MEANING	SYNONYMS (easy words)	ANTONYMS (opposites)	EXAMPLE	SOURCE
Galvanise	*verb*	to shock people into action	stir, push into action		*The tragedy galvanised the public to demand reforms*	News·S
Gambit	*noun*	a clever first move made to gain an advantage	move, trick, plan	blunder, mistake, slip, misstep	*The early announcement of welfare schemes was seen as a political gambit before the polls*	News·Y
Garner	*verb*	to collect or gather, especially support, votes, or attention	gather, collect, get	lose, give, spend, scatter, distribute, disperse, dissipate	*The new welfare scheme has managed to garner wide support across rural districts ahead of the state elections*	News·Y
Gauge	*verb*	to measure or judge something	measure, judge, check	guess, misjudge, estimate, miscalculate, overlook	*The survey was designed to gauge public opinion on the new tax*	News·Y
Germane	*adjective*	closely connected and relevant to the topic	related, relevant, fitting	unrelated, off-topic, irrelevant, immaterial, inapplicable	*The judge ruled that the old records were germane to the present case*	News·Y
Germinal	*adjective*	in the earliest stage; a starting point that things grow from	early, beginning, seed-stage		*The 1953 paper is now seen as a germinal work in the field of genetics*	Journal
Germinate	*verb*	to begin to grow or develop, like a seed or an idea	sprout, begin, develop	die, wither, fade, shrivel, decay	*The idea of a national health scheme germinated decades before it became law*	News·Y
Gerrymander	*verb*	to redraw voting area borders unfairly to help one party win	rig, manipulate, twist		*Critics allege the new constituency map was gerrymandered to favour the ruling party*	News·Y
Glaring	*adjective*	very obvious and bad; easy to notice	obvious, clear, plain	hidden, slight, minor, unnoticed, subtle, inconspicuous, concealed	*The audit exposed glaring lapses in the way relief funds were distributed during the floods*	News·Y
Gloss over	*phrasal verb*	to hide or ignore something bad to make it seem less serious	hide, ignore, cover	highlight, stress, reveal, expose, emphasise, uncover, scrutinise	*The minister's speech tried to gloss over the delays that have plagued the highway project for years*	News·Y
Goad	*verb*	to push or provoke someone into doing something	push, provoke, force	calm, soothe, discourage, stop, deter, dissuade, pacify	*Opposition members tried to goad the treasury benches into a debate on the fuel price hike*	News·Y
Governance	*noun*	the way a country or organisation is run and controlled	management, ruling, running		*Weak governance and corruption slowed the delivery of aid, according to the World Bank assessment*	Journal
Grandiose	*adjective*	too large or showy in plan, often more impressive in words than in reality	showy, huge, over-the-top	simple, plain, modest, humble, ordinary, unpretentious	*The minister's grandiose promise of smart cities remains far from reality in most districts*	News·Y
Grandstanding	*noun*	acting or speaking only to impress people, not to help	showing off, posing, boasting	modest, humble, sincere, genuine, unassuming, understated	*Critics dismissed the leader's remarks as mere grandstanding ahead of the budget session*	News·Y
Grapple	*verb*	to struggle hard to deal with a problem	struggle, fight, handle	avoid, ignore, dodge, evade, sidestep, shirk	*States continue to grapple with rising unemployment among the youth*	News·Y
Grassroots	*adjective*	starting from ordinary people at the local level, not from leaders at the top	local, bottom-up, community		*The campaign relied on a grassroots network of volunteers rather than wealthy corporate donors*	Journal

WORD	POS	MEANING	SYNONYMS (easy words)	ANTONYMS (opposites)	EXAMPLE	SOURCE
Gregarious	*adjective*	fond of company; very social and friendly	social, friendly, outgoing	shy, quiet, lonely, unfriendly, reserved, antisocial, withdrawn, introverted	*The gregarious leader drew large crowds wherever his roadshow travelled*	News·Y
Grievance	*noun*	a complaint about unfair treatment	complaint, problem, grudge	praise, thanks, contentment, satisfaction	*The protesters said the government had ignored their long-standing grievances*	News·Y
Grim	*adjective*	very serious, worrying, and unpleasant	serious, sad, harsh	happy, bright, cheerful, pleasant, hopeful, encouraging	*The report paints a grim picture of rising unemployment in small towns*	News·Y
Gruelling	*adjective*	very tiring and difficult	tiring, tough, hard	easy, light, simple, relaxing, effortless, undemanding	*After a gruelling round of negotiations, the two parties finally reached a power-sharing agreement*	News·Y
Gulf	*noun*	a very wide gap or difference between two things	gap, divide, distance	closeness, link, bond, nearness, similarity, agreement	*The widening gulf between the rich and the poor remains the country's most pressing challenge*	News·Y
H						
Hail	*verb*	to praise something publicly	praise, welcome		*Leaders hailed the agreement as a historic step*	News·S
Halcyon	*adjective*	peaceful, happy and prosperous (usually about the past)	calm, happy, peaceful	sad, troubled, stormy, unhappy, turbulent, distressing	*Many recall the halcyon days of high growth before the global slowdown set in*	News·Y
Halfhearted	*adjective*	done without real effort or interest	weak, lazy, careless	eager, keen, serious, willing, enthusiastic, wholehearted, committed	*A halfhearted enquiry will only deepen public mistrust in the system*	News·Y
Halt	*verb/noun*	to stop	stop, pause		*Train services came to a halt due to the strike*	News·S
Hamper	*verb*	to slow down or block progress	block, hold back		*Heavy rain hampered rescue operations*	News·S
Hapless	*adjective*	unlucky and unable to do anything about it	unlucky, helpless, poor	lucky, fortunate, blessed, prosperous	*Hapless commuters were left stranded for hours after the sudden transport strike*	News·Y
Harangue	*verb/noun*	a long, angry, scolding speech	scolding, lecture, rant	praise, compliment, soothing words, encouragement	*Instead of a policy plan, the minister offered only a harangue against his rivals*	News·Y
Harbinger	*noun*	a sign that something (often bad) is about to happen	sign, signal, warning	result, outcome, follower, aftermath, consequence	*Falling rural wages may be a harbinger of deeper distress in the farm economy*	News·Y
Hardliner	*noun*	someone who holds strict, uncompromising views, often in politics	tough one, strict person, firm one		*Hardliners in the cabinet rejected any talks with the rebels*	Journal
Harrowing	*adjective*	very distressing and painful to experience	painful, scary, shocking	pleasant, calming, soothing, comforting, relaxing, reassuring	*Survivors gave harrowing accounts of the night the floods swept their village*	News·Y
Headlong	*adverb/adjective*	rushing in fast without thinking	reckless, hasty, quick	careful, slow, cautious, thoughtful, gradual, measured	*The headlong rush to privatise has left many safeguards behind*	News·Y

WORD	POS	MEANING	SYNONYMS (easy words)	ANTONYMS (opposites)	EXAMPLE	SOURCE
Hegemon	*noun*	a country or group that dominates and controls others	leader, boss, ruler	follower, subject, underling, subordinate, vassal	*Smaller nations fear the rising hegemon will dictate terms of regional trade*	News·Y
Hegemony	*noun*	control or dominance of one group over others	dominance, control		*The treaty challenged the region's old hegemony*	News·S
Heinous	*adjective*	extremely wicked or shocking	evil, terrible, cruel	good, kind, gentle, harmless, noble, admirable, virtuous	*The court called the attack one of the most heinous crimes the city had witnessed*	News·Y
Hence	*adverb*	for this reason; therefore	so, therefore, that is why		*Costs rose sharply; hence the steep increase in ticket prices*	Journal
Henceforth	*adverb*	from now on; starting from this time	from now on, in future, after this		*The agency announced that, henceforth, all data would be made public*	Journal
Heterodox	*adjective*	not following accepted or usual beliefs	unusual, different, new	normal, accepted, traditional, conventional, orthodox	*The economist proposed a heterodox remedy that mainstream policymakers dismissed*	News·Y
Heuristic	*noun*	a quick rule of thumb that helps you solve a problem fast, even if not perfectly	shortcut, rough rule, quick method		*Investors often rely on a simple heuristic rather than analysing every data point*	Journal
Heyday	*noun*	the time when something was most successful or powerful	peak, prime, best	downfall, decline, low point, decay, twilight, nadir	*In its heyday, the textile hub employed thousands and powered the local economy*	News·Y
Hidebound	*adjective*	stuck in old ways and unwilling to change	rigid, old-fashioned, narrow	open-minded, flexible, modern, liberal, progressive, broad-minded, unconventional	*Reform stalls because a hidebound bureaucracy resists every new idea*	News·Y
Hike	*noun/verb*	an increase (usually in price or rate)	rise, raise		*A sharp hike in fuel prices has angered commuters*	News·S
Hinder	*verb*	to make something harder or slow it down	block, slow, delay	help, aid, assist, support, ease, promote, facilitate	*Poor road connectivity continues to hinder the growth of rural industries*	News·Y
Hindsight	*noun*	understanding a situation only after it has happened	looking back, afterthought	foresight, prediction, anticipation, forethought, foreknowledge	*In hindsight, the regulator should have acted sooner to prevent the banking collapse*	News·Y
Hinge	*verb*	to depend completely on something	depend, rely, rest		*The success of the scheme hinges on how quickly funds reach the districts*	News·Y
Histrionic	*adjective*	overly dramatic and fake in showing feelings	dramatic, fake, showy	calm, quiet, natural, restrained, low-key, undramatic	*The histrionic walkout in Parliament drew cameras but solved nothing*	News·Y
Hitherto	*adverb*	up until now; before this time	so far, until now, previously		*The telescope revealed structures hitherto unseen at the edge of the galaxy*	Journal
Holistic	*adjective*	looking at the whole thing, not just separate parts	whole, complete, all-round		*The Lancet review recommended a holistic approach to health that includes housing and clean water*	Journal

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Homogeneous	*adjective*	made of parts that are all the same	same, uniform, alike	mixed, different, varied, diverse, assorted, heterogeneous	*India is far too diverse to be governed as a single homogeneous bloc*	News·Y
Hostilities	*noun*	acts of war or open fighting	fighting, war, combat		*Hostilities resumed within hours of the ceasefire collapsing*	Journal
Hubris	*noun*	too much pride or over-confidence that leads to a fall	pride, ego, arrogance	shyness, modesty, humility, meekness, humbleness, diffidence	*The party's electoral hubris blinded it to growing anger on the ground*	News·Y
Hurdle	*noun*	a problem or difficulty that must be solved	problem, barrier, obstacle	help, aid, advantage, support, boost	*Poor road connectivity remains the biggest hurdle to rural growth*	News·Y
Husbandry	*noun*	careful management of resources	care, management, saving	waste, carelessness, mismanagement, neglect, extravagance, squandering	*Prudent fiscal husbandry, not reckless spending, is what the struggling economy demands*	News·Y
Hypothesis	*noun*	an idea or guess that you test to see if it is true	guess, idea, theory		*Researchers tested the hypothesis that warmer oceans speed up the spread of the disease*	Journal
I						
Illusory	*adjective*	based on something false; not real	false, fake, unreal	real, true, actual, genuine, factual, tangible, substantial	*Promises of overnight prosperity are illusory and only deepen public disappointment*	News·Y
Imminent	*adjective*	about to happen very soon	near, close		*Weather officials warned of an imminent cyclone*	News·S
Impasse	*noun*	a situation where no progress is possible; a deadlock	deadlock, standstill, dead end	solution, way out, agreement, breakthrough, resolution, progress	*Talks between the unions and the management reached an impasse over the question of minimum wages*	News·Y
Impede	*verb*	to slow down or block progress	block, slow, stop	help, aid, allow, assist, advance, promote, facilitate	*Poor roads continue to impede the growth of trade in the region*	News·Y
Impetuous	*adjective*	acting quickly without thinking	hasty, rash, sudden	careful, calm, slow, cautious, thoughtful, deliberate, prudent	*The government's impetuous decision to demonetise caught even its own officials by surprise*	News·Y
Impetus	*noun*	a force that drives something forward	push, drive		*The reform gave a fresh impetus to growth*	News·S
Impunity	*noun*	freedom from being punished for a wrong act	no punishment, escape, freedom	punishment, penalty, liability, accountability, responsibility, culpability, answerability	*The editorial warned that when powerful officials act with impunity, ordinary citizens lose all faith in the rule of law*	News·Y
Inadvertent	*adjective*	done by mistake, not on purpose	accidental		*An inadvertent error in the data delayed the results*	News·S
Incendiary	*adjective*	likely to cause anger or violence	fiery, inflaming, provoking	calming, soothing, peaceful, gentle, mild, pacifying, conciliatory	*Leaders must avoid incendiary speeches that can ignite communal tensions overnight*	News·Y
Incentive	*noun*	something that encourages you to act, often a reward	reward, push, reason		*Tax breaks gave companies a strong incentive to invest in clean technology*	Journal

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Inclusive	*adjective*	including everyone, leaving no group out	open, welcoming, for all		*The UN praised the country's inclusive policy that brought women into the workforce*	Journal
Inconclusive	*adjective*	not giving a clear answer or final result	unclear, undecided, open		*The early findings were inconclusive, so the team called for further research*	Journal
Incremental	*adjective*	happening in small steps rather than all at once	step-by-step, gradual, slow		*Progress on the disease has been incremental, with each study adding a little*	Journal
Incumbent	*noun/adjective*	the person currently holding an office; also a duty placed on someone	sitting leader, current holder, duty	challenger, newcomer, successor, candidate, contender, outsider	*The incumbent chief minister faces strong anti-establishment sentiment ahead of the polls*	News·Y
Indebtedness	*noun*	the condition of owing a large amount of money	debt load, owing money, debt burden		*Household indebtedness reached record highs as families borrowed to cover rising bills*	Journal
Indicate	*verb*	to show or point to something	show, point to, suggest		*Early results indicate that the vaccine is safe for young children*	Journal
Indictment	*noun*	a formal charge of a crime, or strong criticism	charge, blame, accusation	praise, approval, acquittal, exoneration, vindication, absolution, commendation	*Rising malnutrition figures are a damning indictment of the state's much-publicised welfare schemes*	News·Y
Indigenous	*adjective*	Belonging naturally to a place; the original people or species of a region	native, original, local		*The dam project threatens lands long held by indigenous communities*	Journal
Indolent	*adjective*	lazy and avoiding work or effort	lazy, idle, slow	hardworking, active, busy, energetic, diligent, industrious, assiduous	*The report blames an indolent bureaucracy for the long delay in clearing pending files*	News·Y
Ineluctable	*adjective*	impossible to avoid	unavoidable		*Reform became an ineluctable necessity*	News·S
Inert	*adjective*	lacking energy or the will to act	still, lifeless, inactive	active, lively, moving, energetic, dynamic, reactive, animated	*Civil society cannot remain inert while basic freedoms are being eroded*	News·Y
Inexorable	*adjective*	impossible to stop	unstoppable		*The inexorable rise of automation is changing jobs*	News·S
Infer	*verb*	to work out a conclusion from the evidence	conclude, work out, gather		*From the fossil record, scientists infer that the climate was once far warmer*	Journal
Inflation	*noun*	the general rise in prices over time	price rise		*Rising inflation has hit middle-class families hard*	News·S
Inherent	*adjective*	existing as a natural, permanent part of something; built in	built-in, natural, part of		*There is an inherent risk in lending money to unstable governments*	Journal
Inimical	*adjective*	harmful or hostile to something	harmful, against		*Such policies are inimical to small traders*	News·S
Inimitable	*adjective*	so good or unique it cannot be copied	one-of-a-kind, special, unmatched	common, ordinary, copyable, average, unremarkable, commonplace	*The veteran cartoonist captured the nation's mood with his inimitable wit*	News·Y

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Iniquity	*noun*	great injustice or wickedness	wrong, evil, unfairness	goodness, fairness, justice, virtue, righteousness, morality, integrity	*The court called the bonded-labour system a gross iniquity that shames a modern democracy*	News·Y
Innocuous	*adjective*	harmless	safe, harmless		*What seemed an innocuous remark triggered a big row*	News·S
Insatiable	*adjective*	impossible to satisfy; always wanting more	greedy, never full, endless	satisfied, content, full, limited, satiable	*The city's insatiable demand for water is rapidly draining the lakes around it*	News·Y
Insidious	*adjective*	harmful in a slow, hidden way	sneaky, harmful	harmless, open, honest, obvious, direct, forthright	*Misinformation spreads in an insidious manner*	News·S
Insidiously	*adverb*	in a slow, hidden, harmful way	secretly, slowly, sneakily	openly, plainly, clearly, honestly, harmlessly, conspicuously, overtly	*Communal prejudice spreads insidiously through everyday speech long before it erupts into violence*	News·Y
Insofar	*adverb*	to the extent that; only as far as	as much as, to the point that, where		*The model is useful insofar as it predicts short-term shifts, but it fails over longer periods*	Journal
insofar as	*phrase*	to the extent that; only as much as	as far as, to the degree that		*The plan helps the poor only insofar as funds actually reach them*	Journal
Insolvent	*adjective*	unable to pay one's debts	broke, bankrupt, ruined	rich, wealthy, solvent, debt-free, financially sound, creditworthy	*Several power companies turned insolvent after the regulator slashed tariffs*	News·Y
Insular	*adjective*	closed off and not open to other ideas or people	closed, narrow, cut-off	open, friendly, broad-minded, worldly, cosmopolitan, tolerant, receptive	*Critics say the party's insular leadership has lost touch with the aspirations of young India*	News·Y
Insurgency	*noun*	an armed uprising against a government	rebellion, revolt, uprising		*The decade-long insurgency has displaced millions across the region*	Journal
Insurmountable	*adjective*	too great to be overcome	impossible, too big, unbeatable	easy, beatable, manageable, conquerable, surmountable, achievable	*With political will, even seemingly insurmountable challenges of poverty can be tackled*	News·Y
Insurrection	*noun*	a violent uprising against authority or the state	revolt, uprising, rebellion		*Leaders of the failed insurrection were charged with treason*	Journal
inter alia	*phrase*	'among other things' - shows the listed items are only some of many	among other things, including		*The report criticised, inter alia, weak data and poor oversight*	Journal
Interdict	*verb*	to stop or block something officially	block, stop, ban	allow, permit, approve, authorize, sanction, license, endorse	*Coast Guard ships moved to interdict the boats suspected of smuggling contraband*	News·Y
Interlocutor	*noun*	a person appointed to talk and negotiate, especially in a dispute	negotiator, talker, go-between	listener, bystander, onlooker, observer	*The Centre named a senior interlocutor to begin dialogue with the agitating farmers*	News·Y
Interregnum	*noun*	a gap period between two governments or rulers	gap, in-between, pause	continuity, stability, reign, continuation	*During the political interregnum, key reforms were left hanging in uncertainty*	News·Y

WORD	POS	MEANING	SYNONYMS (easy words)	ANTONYMS (opposites)	EXAMPLE	SOURCE
Intervention	*noun*	an action taken to change or improve a situation	action, step in, help		*Early health interventions, such as vaccines, save millions of children each year*	Journal
Intractable	*adjective*	very hard to solve or control	stubborn, hard, difficult	easy, manageable, simple, solvable, obedient, controllable, tractable	*The water-sharing dispute between the two states has proved intractable despite years of talks*	News·Y
Intransigent	*adjective*	refusing to change one's view	stubborn, rigid		*Both sides remained intransigent, and talks failed*	News·S
Intrinsic	*adjective*	belonging naturally to something	natural, built-in, basic		*Trust is an intrinsic part of any functioning market*	Journal
Invective	*noun*	harsh, insulting, abusive language	abuse, insults, harsh words	praise, compliment, kind words, flattery, commendation, eulogy, panegyric	*Parliamentary debate has degenerated into personal invective rather than reasoned argument*	News·Y
J						
Jeopardise	*verb*	to put something at risk of harm or failure	risk, endanger, threaten	protect, save, secure, guard, safeguard, preserve	*Cutting health budgets could jeopardise years of progress against disease*	News·Y
Jettison	*verb*	to throw away or abandon something	dump, drop, discard	keep, hold, save, retain, accept, embrace, preserve	*The ruling alliance was forced to jettison the unpopular land law after public outcry*	News·Y
Jingoism	*noun*	extreme, aggressive love of one's country	blind pride, nationalism, boasting	peace-loving, internationalism, pacifism, cosmopolitanism	*Sober debate gave way to jingoism whenever the border issue was raised*	News·Y
Jubilant	*adjective*	feeling and showing great joy	very happy, joyful, cheerful	sad, unhappy, gloomy, miserable, dejected, despondent, sorrowful	*Party workers were jubilant after the surprise win, but the editorial urged them to focus on governance instead*	News·Y
Juncture	*noun*	an important point in time	moment, point, stage		*At this critical juncture, the economy needs steady hands rather than populist promises*	News·Y
Jurisprudence	*noun*	the study or philosophy of law	law theory, legal thinking, law study		*The verdict marks an important advance in Indian environmental jurisprudence*	News·Y
Juxtapose	*verb*	to place two things side by side to compare them	place together, set side by side, compare	separate, divide, split, part, disconnect, isolate	*The article juxtaposes the city's gleaming new airport with the slums next to it to expose unequal growth*	News·Y
K						
Keen	*adjective*	sharp, strong, and quick to understand or feel	sharp, eager, alert	dull, slow, blunt, weak, uninterested, indifferent, apathetic	*The committee showed a keen awareness of how inflation hits the poorest households hardest*	News·Y
Keystone	*noun*	the most important part on which everything else depends	base, main support, anchor	extra, minor part, side detail, trifle	*Affordable public healthcare remains the keystone of any credible welfare promise made before the elections*	News·Y
Kindle	*verb*	to start or stir up a feeling	start, light, stir	stop, end, kill, calm, extinguish, quench, smother	*The young leader's speech kindled fresh hope among first-time voters*	News·Y

WORD	POS	MEANING	SYNONYMS (easy words)	ANTONYMS (opposites)	EXAMPLE	SOURCE
Kinetic	*adjective*	full of active movement and energy	moving, active, lively	still, motionless, fixed, inactive, static, stationary	*The minister promised a more kinetic foreign policy that responds quickly to events in the neighbourhood*	News·Y
Knell	*noun*	a sign or sound warning that something is ending or dying	death sign, warning bell, end signal	beginning, birth, dawn, rise, revival	*Falling enrolment may sound the knell for hundreds of small government schools across the state*	News·Y
Kowtow	*verb*	to obey or please someone powerful in a weak, servile way	bow, give in, flatter	resist, defy, stand up to, oppose, disobey	*The editorial warned that regulators must not kowtow to powerful corporate lobbies while framing data-protection rules*	News·Y
L						
Labyrinthine	*adjective*	extremely complicated and confusing, like a maze	complex, confusing, twisting	simple, easy, clear, plain, straightforward, uncomplicated	*Small traders complain that the labyrinthine tax-filing process drives them to expensive consultants they can ill afford*	News·Y
Lachrymose	*adjective*	tearful or causing tears; full of sadness	tearful, sad, weepy	happy, cheerful, joyful, smiling, gleeful, mirthful	*The editorial dismissed the leader's lachrymose appeal as a calculated bid for sympathy before the verdict*	News·Y
Laconic	*adjective*	using very few words; brief in speech	short, brief, few words	talkative, wordy, chatty, long-winded, verbose, garrulous, loquacious	*The minister's laconic reply to pointed questions only deepened suspicions of a cover-up*	News·Y
Lacuna	*noun*	a gap or missing part, especially in a law or argument	gap, hole, missing piece	fullness, completeness, whole, continuity, entirety	*The new data-protection bill leaves a serious lacuna by not covering government surveillance*	News·Y
Lag	*verb*	to move or develop more slowly than others	trail, fall behind, slow	lead, hurry, rush, advance, outpace	*Rural schools continue to lag behind urban ones in basic facilities*	News·Y
Lambast	*verb*	to criticise someone harshly	attack, scold, blast	praise, applaud, compliment, commend, laud, extol	*Opposition leaders lambasted the government for what they called a budget that ignored the poor*	News·Y
Lament	*verb*	to express deep sadness or regret about something	mourn, regret, grieve	celebrate, rejoice, cheer, delight, applaud	*Editorials across the nation lamented the loss of the veteran journalist*	News·Y
Languid	*adjective*	slow, relaxed, and lacking energy	slow, lazy, weak	active, lively, fast, energetic, brisk, vigorous, spirited	*After a languid first half, the budget session finally sprang to life over the contentious farm bill*	News·Y
Languish	*verb*	to remain in a bad or weak state for a long time	suffer, weaken, waste away	grow, rise, thrive, flourish, prosper, bloom	*Thousands of undertrials continue to languish in jails awaiting trial*	News·Y
Largesse	*noun*	generous giving of money or gifts, often by the powerful	giving, generosity, handouts	meanness, stinginess, greed, selfishness, miserliness, parsimony	*Pre-election largesse in the form of free schemes has strained the state's finances*	News·Y
Lassitude	*noun*	a feeling of tiredness and lack of energy or interest	tiredness, weariness, dullness	energy, freshness, liveliness, vigour, vitality, alertness	*A sense of policy lassitude has gripped the bureaucracy, with key reforms gathering dust for years*	News·Y
Latent	*adjective*	present but hidden and not yet active or visible	hidden, sleeping, unseen	active, open, clear, visible, obvious, apparent, manifest	*The protests exposed a latent anger over joblessness that the government had long ignored*	News·Y

WORD	POS	MEANING	SYNONYMS (easy words)	ANTONYMS (opposites)	EXAMPLE	SOURCE
Laud	*verb*	to praise someone or something publicly	praise, applaud, honour	blame, criticise, scold, condemn, denounce, vilify	*Economists lauded the central bank for holding interest rates steady amid global uncertainty*	News·Y
Laudable	*adjective*	deserving praise	praiseworthy, good, admirable	shameful, bad, blameworthy, disgraceful, contemptible, deplorable, reprehensible	*The scheme's intent is laudable, but its execution on the ground has been poor*	News·Y
Legitimacy	*noun*	the quality of being accepted as rightful and lawful by the people	rightfulness, acceptance, validity		*After the disputed count, the new government struggled to establish its legitimacy in the eyes of voters*	Journal
Lenient	*adjective*	not strict; gentle in punishment	soft, gentle, easy	strict, hard, harsh, severe, tough, rigid	*The opposition accused the agency of being lenient with powerful offenders*	News·Y
Leverage	*noun*	the use of borrowed money to try to make bigger profits	borrowed money, debt power, gearing		*The bank's heavy leverage magnified its losses when asset prices tumbled*	Journal
Levity	*noun*	a lack of seriousness; treating something serious as a joke	joking, lightness, fun	seriousness, gravity, solemnity, sobriety, earnestness	*Treating a grave farmer-distress crisis with such levity does the ruling party no credit*	News·Y
Levy	*noun/verb*	a tax or charge placed by the government	tax, charge, fee	refund, rebate, exemption, repayment, remission	*The new levy on imported goods drew sharp criticism from traders*	News·Y
Licentious	*adjective*	behaving without moral restraint, especially in a sexual or lawless way	wild, immoral, unrestrained	moral, decent, pure, modest, chaste, virtuous, disciplined	*The film board defended its cuts, arguing the scenes were gratuitously licentious rather than artistic*	News·Y
Liminal	*adjective*	being at a boundary or in-between, transitional stage	in-between, borderline, transitional	settled, fixed, stable, clear, defined, permanent	*The economy occupies a liminal space, no longer poor but not yet rich, where old policies no longer fit*	News·Y
Linear	*adjective*	changing at a steady, straight-line rate	straight, even, steady		*The relationship between dose and effect was roughly linear up to a point*	Journal
Liquidity	*noun*	how easily money or assets can be spent or sold quickly	ready cash, spendable money, cash flow		*The central bank pumped liquidity into banks to keep lending from freezing up*	Journal
Litany	*noun*	a long, repeated list, usually of complaints or problems	long list, string, series	summary, few, handful, brief mention	*The audit report reads like a litany of lapses, from missing files to inflated bills*	News·Y
Livelihood	*noun*	the way someone earns money to live	income, job, living		*Drought has destroyed the livelihoods of millions of farmers across the Sahel, the agency reported*	Journal
Loom	*verb*	to appear close and threatening; about to happen	approach, threaten, near	fade, recede, disappear, vanish, retreat	*A severe water crisis looms over several cities this summer*	News·Y
Loquacious	*adjective*	talking a lot; very talkative	talkative, chatty, wordy	quiet, silent, shy, reserved, tight-lipped, taciturn, laconic	*The usually loquacious spokesman fell oddly silent when reporters raised the funding scandal*	News·Y
Lucrative	*adjective*	earning a lot of money	profitable		*The deal opened up a lucrative market for Indian firms*	News·S
Lugubrious	*adjective*	looking or sounding very sad and gloomy	gloomy, sad, dismal	happy, cheerful, bright, joyful, lively, jovial	*There was a lugubrious mood in the markets as one weak earnings report followed another*	News·Y

WORD	POS	MEANING	SYNONYMS (easy words)	ANTONYMS (opposites)	EXAMPLE	SOURCE
M						
Machination	*noun*	a secret clever plan to do something harmful	scheme, plot, trick	honesty, openness, fair dealing, frankness	*The Opposition accused ruling parties of political machinations to topple the state government*	News·Y
Machinations	*noun*	secret clever plans or scheming to do harm	plotting, scheming, tricks	honesty, openness, fairness, frankness, candour, transparency	*The fall of the coalition was blamed on the backroom machinations of a handful of power brokers*	News·Y
Magnitude	*noun*	the size or scale of something	size, scale, amount		*The magnitude of the temperature rise surprised even the most senior climate scientists*	Journal
Malaise	*noun*	a general feeling that something is wrong, weak, or unhealthy	unease, weakness, sickness	wellness, health, comfort, ease, wellbeing, vigour	*The slowdown in manufacturing reflects a deeper malaise in the country's investment climate*	News·Y
Mandate	*noun*	the power/permission given by people's votes	authority, approval		*The party won a clear mandate in the election*	News·S
Manifest	*verb*	to show or appear clearly	show, appear, reveal		*The disease often manifests as fatigue long before other symptoms emerge*	Journal
Manifold	*adjective*	many and of several kinds	many, varied, numerous		*The benefits of vaccination are manifold and well documented*	Journal
Margin	*noun*	the small extra amount or gap, often of error or difference	gap, edge, difference		*The poll has a margin of error of plus or minus three percentage points*	Journal
Margin of error	*noun*	the small range a result may be off by	allowance, give-or-take, range		*The poll showed 52 percent support, with a margin of error of three points*	Journal
Marginal	*adjective*	very small; only just big enough to notice	tiny, slight, small		*The vaccine showed only a marginal benefit in older patients, the researchers cautioned*	Journal
Marginalise	*verb*	to push a group to the edges of society, ignoring their needs	sideline, exclude, push aside		*The policy further marginalised migrant communities already cut off from healthcare and schooling*	Journal
Measure	*verb*	to find out the size, amount, or level of something	check, count, size up		*The team used satellites to measure the rate of ice loss in Antarctica*	Journal
Mediate	*verb*	to help two sides settle a dispute	settle, help, intervene	fight, divide, provoke, inflame, aggravate	*The Centre offered to mediate between the two states over the river dispute*	News·Y
Mendacious	*adjective*	lying, not telling the truth	dishonest, false		*The report was dismissed as mendacious propaganda*	News·S
Mercurial	*adjective*	changing moods or behaviour quickly and unpredictably	moody, changing, unstable	steady, calm, stable, constant, predictable, even-tempered	*Investors remain wary of the mercurial policy shifts that have rattled markets twice this year*	News·Y
Meritocracy	*noun*	a system where people rise based on talent and effort, not birth or wealth	earned success, talent rule		*The civil-service exam was designed to build a meritocracy in which ability, not connections, determined advancement*	Journal

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Methodology	*noun*	the set of methods used to do research	method, approach, procedure		*Critics questioned the study's methodology and small sample size*	Journal
Meticulous	*adjective*	very careful and paying great attention to detail	careful, thorough, exact	careless, sloppy, messy, hasty, negligent, slapdash	*The agency's meticulous investigation left the accused with little room to escape the charges*	News·Y
Misnomer	*noun*	a wrong or unsuitable name for something	wrong name, false label, misleading title	correct name, proper name, accurate name	*Calling the levy a 'service charge' is a misnomer, since citizens get no service in return*	News·Y
Mitigate	*verb*	to make a bad thing less harmful	reduce, soften		*Tree plantation can help mitigate the effects of heatwaves*	News·S
Mitigation	*noun*	action taken to make a problem less serious	easing, reducing, softening		*Climate mitigation focuses on cutting emissions, while adaptation prepares us for warming already locked in*	Journal
Mobilise	*verb*	to organise and bring people together for a cause or action	rally, gather, stir up		*Activists used encrypted apps to mobilise thousands of protesters within hours of the announcement*	Journal
Mollify	*verb*	to make someone less angry; to calm them down	calm, soothe, soften	anger, upset, annoy, provoke, irritate, aggravate, enrage	*The government cut fuel taxes to mollify the protesting transport unions*	News·Y
Monetary	*adjective*	relating to money supply and interest rates set by a central bank	money, cash, interest-rate		*The Federal Reserve signalled a shift to looser monetary policy to support growth*	Journal
Morass	*noun*	a confusing and difficult situation that is hard to escape	mess, trap, swamp	order, clarity, simplicity, ease, way out, solution	*The project sank into a legal morass of clearances, appeals and stay orders that lasted a decade*	News·Y
Moratorium	*noun*	An official temporary stop or pause on an activity	pause, halt, freeze		*The country declared a moratorium on whaling to let stocks recover*	Journal
Moribund	*adjective*	almost dead or about to fail completely	dying, failing, weak	healthy, growing, alive, lively, thriving, flourishing, vigorous	*The package aims to revive a moribund manufacturing sector*	News·Y
Mull	*verb*	to think about carefully	consider		*The cabinet is mulling a new tax on luxury cars*	News·S
Multilateral	*adjective*	involving many countries acting together	many-sided, group, joint		*The crisis can only be solved through a multilateral effort backed by the UN*	Journal
Munificence	*noun*	great generosity in giving	generosity, giving, kindness	stinginess, meanness, greed, selfishness, miserliness	*The trust survives on the munificence of a few wealthy donors*	News·Y
Munificent	*adjective*	very generous in giving	generous, giving, kind	stingy, mean, selfish, miserly, tight-fisted, parsimonious	*The munificent corporate donations to the relief fund were welcome, yet they masked the state's own failures*	News·Y
Myriad	*adjective/ noun*	a very large number	countless, many	few, little, scarce, handful, scanty	*Farmers face a myriad of problems every season*	News·S
Myriad	*noun*	a very large number of things; countless many	countless, many, loads	few, little, scarce, handful, scanty	*The scheme faces a myriad of hurdles, from funding gaps to poor staffing*	News·Y
N						

WORD	POS	MEANING	SYNONYMS (easy words)	ANTONYMS (opposites)	EXAMPLE	SOURCE
Nab	*verb*	to catch or arrest	catch, arrest		*Police nabbed two suspects near the border*	News·S
Nadir	*noun*	the lowest or worst point of something	lowest point, bottom, rock-bottom	top, peak, height, summit, zenith, apex, pinnacle	*Relations between the two neighbours hit a nadir after the border clash last winter*	News·Y
Nascent	*adjective*	just beginning to develop	new, young		*India's nascent semiconductor industry needs support*	News·S
Nationalism	*noun*	strong loyalty to one's own nation, often above other nations	patriotism, national pride, loyalty		*Rising nationalism has made cross-border cooperation far harder*	Journal
Nebulous	*adjective*	vague, unclear and hard to understand	vague, unclear, fuzzy	clear, exact, plain, definite, precise, distinct, well-defined	*The scheme rests on nebulous targets that no one can actually measure*	News·Y
Negligence	*noun*	failure to take proper care	carelessness, neglect, oversight		*The inquiry blamed the disaster on official negligence*	Journal
Negligible	*adjective*	so small it can be safely ignored	tiny, unimportant, barely there		*The added risk from the chemical was found to be negligible at normal doses*	Journal
Neutrality	*noun*	the policy of not taking sides in a conflict	non-involvement, staying out, fairness		*The small state has guarded its neutrality through every regional war*	Journal
Nominal	*adjective*	in name only; very small or not really meaningful	in name only, tiny, slight		*The state retains nominal control of the port, but a foreign firm runs daily operations*	Journal
Nonchalant	*adjective*	calm and not worried, showing no concern	casual, cool, unbothered	worried, nervous, anxious, concerned, excited, tense, agitated	*The officials seemed nonchalant about the rising debt, brushing aside the warnings*	News·Y
Normative	*adjective*	about how things should be, not just how they are - based on rules or values	about what is right, value-based, should-based		*The paper shifts from describing inequality to making a normative claim that it must be reduced*	Journal
nota bene	*abbreviation*	'note well' (often written N.B.) - draws attention to an important point	note this, take note, important		*N.B.: the figures exclude inflation, the authors stressed*	Journal
Notable	*adjective*	important or worth noticing	important, well-known, special	ordinary, common, minor, unknown, unremarkable, insignificant	*There has been a notable improvement in literacy rates over the decade*	News·Y
Notwithstanding	*preposition*	in spite of; despite	despite, even with, regardless of		*Notwithstanding the funding cuts, the laboratory completed its trials on schedule*	Journal
Nuance	*noun*	a small, fine difference in meaning	subtle point		*The debate ignored the nuances of the policy*	News·S
Nuanced	*adjective*	showing fine, careful differences and detail	subtle, detailed, careful		*The journalist offered a nuanced account that resisted easy heroes and villains*	Journal
Nullify	*verb*	to make something lose its legal force or value; to cancel it	cancel, void, undo	allow, keep, approve, confirm, validate, uphold, ratify, enforce	*The High Court moved to nullify the contract awarded without open bidding*	News·Y
O						
Obdurate	*adjective*	stubbornly refusing to change	stubborn		*The management stayed obdurate despite the strike*	News·S

WORD	POS	MEANING	SYNONYMS (easy words)	ANTONYMS (opposites)	EXAMPLE	SOURCE
Obfuscate	*verb*	to deliberately make something unclear	confuse, hide	explain, clear up, clarify, simplify, illuminate, elucidate	*The reply only obfuscated the real cost of the project*	News·S
Obfuscation	*noun*	deliberately making something confusing to hide the truth	confusion, cover-up, blurring	clearness, clarity, explanation, simplification, transparency, elucidation, lucidity	*The minister's reply was a masterclass in obfuscation, dodging every pointed question*	News·Y
Obloquy	*noun*	strong public criticism and shame	disgrace, blame		*The scandal brought obloquy on the whole party*	News·S
Obsequious	*adjective*	too eager to please / overly obedient	servile		*His obsequious manner annoyed his colleagues*	News·S
Observe	*verb*	to watch carefully and notice what happens	watch, notice, see		*Astronomers observed the distant star dimming over several weeks*	Journal
Obstinate	*adjective*	refusing to change one's mind even when wrong	stubborn, hard-headed, fixed	flexible, easygoing, agreeable, yielding, cooperative, compliant, amenable	*The government's obstinate refusal to talk to the protesters only deepened the crisis*	News·Y
Offset	*verb*	to balance out or cancel one effect with another	balance, cancel out, make up for		*Gains in solar power were offset by rising demand for air conditioning*	Journal
Ominous	*adjective*	suggesting that something bad will happen	scary, gloomy, threatening	hopeful, lucky, promising, encouraging, favourable, auspicious, propitious	*The ominous fall in factory output points to deeper trouble in the economy*	News·Y
Onerous	*adjective*	needing much effort; heavy and hard to bear	heavy, hard, tough	easy, light, simple, effortless, undemanding, manageable, untroublesome	*Small businesses say the new compliance rules are far too onerous to follow*	News·Y
Ontological	*adjective*	about the nature of being - what things really are, or whether they exist at all	about existence, about what is real		*Philosophers raised ontological questions about whether a digital mind could truly be said to exist*	Journal
Onus	*noun*	the duty or responsibility to do something	duty, burden, job	freedom, exemption, release	*The onus is on the state to ensure clean drinking water for all*	News·Y
Opaque	*adjective*	not clear or open; hard to understand	unclear, hidden, murky	clear, see-through, plain, obvious, transparent, lucid, translucent	*The opaque manner of awarding contracts has raised serious questions about transparency*	News·Y
Ostensible	*adjective*	appearing true on the surface, but maybe not real	apparent, so-called		*The ostensible reason for the visit was trade*	News·S
Ostensibly	*adverb*	according to what is claimed, though perhaps not truly	supposedly, apparently, seemingly		*The troops were sent ostensibly to keep the peace, but critics saw a land grab*	Journal
Ostentatious	*adjective*	showing off wealth to impress	showy, flashy		*The ostentatious wedding drew public criticism*	News·S
Oust	*verb*	to force someone out of power	remove, throw out		*The party voted to oust its own leader*	News·S
Outcome	*noun*	the result or effect that comes out of something	result, effect, end		*Better health outcomes were seen in regions with more clean drinking water*	Journal

WORD	POS	MEANING	SYNONYMS (easy words)	ANTONYMS (opposites)	EXAMPLE	SOURCE
Outlier	*noun*	a result that is very different from all the others	odd one out, exception, stray result		*One outlier showed a huge effect, but the rest of the data was flat*	Journal
Outset	*noun*	the very beginning of something	start, beginning, opening	end, finish, close, ending, conclusion, finale, termination	*From the outset, the policy lacked a clear plan to fund its lofty promises*	News·Y
Overheating	*noun*	an economy growing too fast, risking high inflation	running too hot, overgrowth, boiling over		*Analysts warned of overheating as cheap credit fuelled runaway property prices*	Journal
P						
Palliative	*adjective/ noun*	giving short-term relief but not curing the real problem	soothing, temporary, stop-gap	curing, healing, curative, remedial	*Critics argued that the cash handout was a mere palliative that ignored the deeper crisis of rural unemployment*	News·Y
Palpable	*adjective*	so strong it can almost be felt or touched	clear, obvious, strong	hidden, unclear, faint, vague, slight, imperceptible, intangible	*There was palpable anger among voters over the sudden hike in electricity bills*	News·Y
Panacea	*noun*	a cure for all problems (usually said it is NOT one)	cure-all	problem, poison, curse, bane, affliction	*Technology is not a panacea for poverty*	News·S
Pandemic	*noun*	A disease outbreak that spreads across many countries or the whole world	global outbreak, plague, epidemic		*The Lancet study modelled how quickly a new pandemic could spread*	Journal
Paradigm	*noun*	a typical model or pattern of doing something	model, pattern		*Remote work has caused a paradigm shift in offices*	News·S
Paradox	*noun*	something that seems to contradict itself but may still be true	contradiction, puzzle, strange truth		*The study highlights the paradox of choice: more options can leave people less happy*	Journal
Parley	*noun/verb*	a formal talk to settle a dispute	talk, discussion, negotiation	fight, war, battle, quarrel, dispute, conflict, hostilities	*After weeks of tension, the two parties agreed to a parley over the contentious border issue*	News·Y
Partisan	*adjective/ noun*	strongly supporting one side, often unfairly	biased, one-sided, loyal	fair, neutral, balanced, unbiased, impartial, nonpartisan, disinterested	*The committee's report was dismissed as partisan, written only to favour the ruling party*	News·Y
Partisanship	*noun*	strong, often blind loyalty to one's own political party	party loyalty, bias, side-taking		*Deep partisanship in the legislature stalled even routine bills that once passed with broad support*	Journal
Partition	*noun*	the division of one country or land into separate parts	division, split, separation		*The partition of the colony left millions displaced across new borders*	Journal
Paucity	*noun*	a shortage or very small amount of something	shortage, lack, scarcity	plenty, lots, excess, abundance, surplus, profusion	*The paucity of reliable data has made it nearly impossible to gauge the scheme's real impact*	News·Y
Penury	*noun*	the state of being extremely poor	poverty, want, hardship	wealth, riches, plenty, prosperity, affluence, opulence	*A single hospital bill can push a near-poor family back into penury, the survey warns*	News·Y
per capita	*phrase*	Latin for 'per head' - for each person, used when comparing countries or groups	per person, for each person		*Per capita income in the region has doubled over the past two decades*	Journal

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per se	*phrase*	'in itself' - used to say a thing on its own, not its effects or links	in itself, by itself		*The policy is not harmful per se, but its timing worried investors*	Journal
Perfidy	*noun*	the act of betraying trust; disloyalty	betrayal, cheating, lies	loyalty, trust, honesty, faithfulness, fidelity, allegiance	*Allies accused the regime of perfidy after it broke the ceasefire pact*	News·Y
Perfunctory	*adjective*	done quickly without real care	careless, half-hearted		*The inquiry was perfunctory and ignored key facts*	News·S
Peripatetic	*adjective*	travelling from place to place; not settled in one spot	travelling, roaming, wandering	settled, fixed, stationary, rooted, sedentary	*The peripatetic life of migrant workers leaves their children with broken, interrupted schooling*	News·Y
Pernicious	*adjective*	causing harm in a slow, hidden way	harmful	helpful, harmless, good, healthy, beneficial, wholesome, innocuous	*Corruption has a pernicious effect on public trust*	News·S
Persist	*verb*	to continue firmly despite difficulty	continue, last, remain	stop, quit, give up, cease, abandon, surrender	*Unemployment is likely to persist unless new industries are set up*	News·Y
Pertinent	*adjective*	directly connected and relevant to the matter	relevant, related, fitting	unrelated, off-topic, irrelevant, unconnected, inappropriate, immaterial, extraneous	*The judge asked only the most pertinent questions about the contract dispute*	News·Y
Placate	*verb*	to make an angry person calm and happy again	calm, soothe, satisfy	anger, upset, annoy, provoke, enrage, aggravate, inflame	*The hurried relief package was clearly meant to placate farmers angry over crop losses*	News·Y
Plateau	*noun*	a level where something stops rising and stays flat	flat stage, level off, steady point		*After years of rapid growth, vaccination rates have hit a plateau across the region*	Journal
Plausible	*adjective*	believable; reasonable enough to be true	believable, likely, reasonable		*The authors offer a plausible explanation for the sudden fall in cases*	Journal
Plea	*noun*	an urgent and emotional request	request, appeal, call	refusal, denial, demand	*The court rejected the plea to delay the eviction of street vendors*	News·Y
Plebiscite	*noun*	a direct vote by all the people on a single important question	public vote, referendum		*The government called a plebiscite to let citizens decide directly whether to amend the constitution*	Journal
Pledge	*verb/noun*	to make a serious promise	promise, vow, commit	break, deny, renounce, retract, repudiate	*The minister pledged to double spending on public health this year*	News·Y
Plight	*noun*	A difficult, dangerous, or sad situation someone is stuck in	trouble, hardship, distress		*The report highlighted the plight of refugees stranded at the border*	Journal
Plummet	*verb*	to fall very fast	crash, drop		*Sales plummeted during the lockdown*	News·S
Plunge	*verb*	to fall suddenly and steeply	crash, drop		*Stock markets plunged amid global tension*	News·S
Plutocracy	*noun*	a society or government controlled by the very rich	rule by the rich, money rule		*Economists warned that rising inequality risked turning the republic into a plutocracy dominated by a few billionaires*	Journal

WORD	POS	MEANING	SYNONYMS (easy words)	ANTONYMS (opposites)	EXAMPLE	SOURCE
Polarisation	*noun*	when people split into two opposing groups with no middle ground	division, splitting, taking sides		*Researchers found that social media accelerates political polarisation by pushing users toward more extreme views*	Journal
Polarise	*verb*	to split people into two opposing groups	divide, split, separate	unite, join, bring together, reconcile, harmonise	*The new law threatens to polarise an already divided society along religious lines*	News·Y
Polity	*noun*	an organised society or state with its own form of government	state, society, nation		*A healthy polity, the scholars argued, depends on citizens who trust shared institutions*	Journal
Populism	*noun*	a style of politics that claims to speak for ordinary people against the elite	people-first politics, mass appeal		*The rise of populism across Europe has unsettled mainstream parties that long dominated the political centre*	Journal
Posit	*verb*	to put forward an idea as true so it can be discussed or tested	suggest, claim, assume		*The authors posit that rising sea temperatures, rather than overfishing, are the main driver of the decline in cod stocks*	Journal
Postulate	*verb*	to suggest an idea as a starting point, before it is proven	suggest, propose, assume		*The authors postulate that warming oceans are driving the change in fish migration*	Journal
Pragmatic	*adjective*	practical, dealing with real facts not ideas	practical, sensible	impractical, dreamy, unrealistic, idealistic, theoretical, romantic, utopian	*A pragmatic approach is needed to solve the water crisis*	News·S
Precarious	*adjective*	unsafe, likely to fail or fall	risky, shaky	safe, stable, steady, secure, firm, settled, reliable	*Millions live in a precarious financial situation*	News·S
Preclude	*verb*	to prevent something from happening; to rule it out	prevent, stop, block		*A lack of funding need not preclude high-quality research, the editorial insists*	Journal
Predicament	*noun*	a difficult situation with no easy way out	trouble, fix		*Migrant workers were left in a desperate predicament*	News·S
Predominant	*adjective*	the most common or strongest	main, leading, chief		*Coal remains the predominant source of power in several economies*	Journal
Preliminary	*adjective*	coming before the main part; early	early, first, initial		*Preliminary results suggest the vaccine is safe*	Journal
Presumably	*adverb*	probably; this is what we assume without full proof	probably, likely, I assume		*The funds were, presumably, redirected to defence, though the budget gave no clear breakdown*	Journal
Prevailing	*adjective*	most common or widely accepted at a given time	common, usual, dominant		*The prevailing view among analysts is that interest rates will hold steady*	Journal
Prevalence	*noun*	how common or widespread something is	commonness, spread, how widespread		*The study found a rising prevalence of diabetes among young adults in cities*	Journal
Prevaricate	*verb*	to avoid telling the truth directly; to speak in a misleading way	dodge, mislead, evade	be honest, be clear, tell the truth, be straight, be candid, be forthright	*Instead of owning the failure, officials chose to prevaricate, blaming everyone but themselves*	News·Y
prima facie	*phrase*	on first look; based on what seems true at first	at first sight, on the surface, apparently		*There is prima facie evidence of fraud, though a full inquiry is still needed*	Journal

WORD	POS	MEANING	SYNONYMS (easy words)	ANTONYMS (opposites)	EXAMPLE	SOURCE
pro rata	*adjective*	in proportion; shared according to each share or part	in proportion, share by share		*Losses were split pro rata among the shareholders*	Journal
Probe	*noun/verb*	an investigation	inquiry, check		*A probe has been ordered into the bridge collapse*	News·S
Profligate	*adjective*	wasteful, especially with money or resources	wasteful, reckless, extravagant	saving, careful, thrifty, economical, frugal, prudent	*Economists warned that profligate spending ahead of the polls would blow a hole in the budget*	News·Y
Projection	*noun*	a forecast of what a number will be in the future	forecast, prediction, outlook		*IMF projections suggest the economy will grow by three percent next year*	Journal
Proliferate	*verb*	to increase quickly in number	multiply, spread, grow	decrease, fall, drop, shrink, decline, dwindle, diminish	*Unregulated coaching centres have proliferated across small towns in recent years*	News·Y
Prompt	*verb*	to cause something to happen or make someone act	cause, lead to, trigger	stop, prevent, discourage, deter, hinder	*The factory fire prompted a fresh review of safety rules in the area*	News·Y
Pronounced	*adjective*	very clear and strong; easy to notice	strong, marked, obvious		*The effect was most pronounced among children under the age of five*	Journal
Propensity	*noun*	a natural tendency to behave in a certain way	tendency, habit, leaning	dislike, hatred, aversion, reluctance, disinclination, antipathy	*The report noted the agency's propensity to delay action until a crisis erupts*	News·Y
Prospective	*adjective*	likely to happen or be in the future	future, expected, possible		*The trial followed prospective patients over five years*	Journal
Protectionism	*noun*	shielding home industries by taxing or blocking foreign goods	trade barriers, home-favouring, walls on trade		*Rising protectionism threatened to unravel decades of open global trade*	Journal
Provisional	*adjective*	for now only; likely to be changed later	temporary, for now, not final		*The provisional figures suggest a record harvest, but they may be revised*	Journal
Proxy	*noun*	a person or group acting for another, often in a hidden war	stand-in, agent, substitute		*Analysts describe the fighting as a proxy war between two larger powers*	Journal
Prudent	*adjective*	sensible and careful in decisions	wise, careful, sensible	careless, foolish, rash, reckless, unwise, imprudent	*Analysts called it a prudent budget that avoided needless spending*	News·Y
Purported	*adjective*	claimed to be, but not proven	alleged, supposed, so-called		*The purported recording of the call could not be confirmed as genuine*	Journal
Purportedly	*adverb*	said to be true by some, but not proven	supposedly, reportedly, claimed to be		*The document, purportedly leaked from the ministry, has not yet been verified by officials*	Journal
Pusillanimous	*adjective*	cowardly, lacking courage	cowardly		*Opponents accused the government of a pusillanimous response*	News·S
Pyrrhic	*adjective*	a win that costs so much it feels like a loss	costly victory		*It was a Pyrrhic victory — they won the case but lost everything*	News·S
Q						
Quagmire	*noun*	a messy situation that is hard to escape	mess, trap	solution, ease, relief, escape	*The legal quagmire has stalled the project for years*	News·S
Qualified	*adjective*	limited or partial; not full or complete (of support, praise, etc.)	limited, partial, with conditions		*The committee gave only qualified support to the plan, noting several serious risks*	Journal

WORD	POS	MEANING	SYNONYMS (easy words)	ANTONYMS (opposites)	EXAMPLE	SOURCE
Quandary	*noun*	a difficult situation where it is hard to decide what to do	fix, confusion, hard choice	certainty, sureness, clarity, ease, confidence	*The government faces a quandary between controlling prices and supporting struggling farmers*	News·Y
Quantify	*verb*	to measure or express something as a number	measure, count, calculate		*The study sought to quantify the economic cost of air pollution*	Journal
Quell	*verb*	to stop or calm something, like protest or fear	stop, calm, control	start, encourage, provoke, incite, stir up, foment	*Police were deployed to quell the violence that broke out near the market*	News·Y
Querulous	*adjective*	complaining in an irritated, whining way	complaining, whining, grumpy	happy, calm, content, cheerful, pleased, easygoing, uncomplaining	*The minister dismissed the querulous opposition as unwilling to offer real solutions*	News·Y
Quintessential	*adjective*	the most perfect example of something	perfect, typical		*He was the quintessential public servant — honest and hardworking*	News·S
Quixotic	*adjective*	unrealistic and impractical in a hopeful way	unrealistic, dreamy		*His quixotic plan to end all poverty won few backers*	News·S
R						
Ramification	*noun*	A result or consequence of an action, often complex and far-reaching	consequence, result, effect		*Economists are still tracing the ramifications of the trade war*	Journal
Rampant	*adjective*	spreading widely and out of control	widespread, wild, uncontrolled	controlled, contained, rare, limited, restrained, checked	*Rampant corruption in the department has shaken public trust*	News·Y
Random	*adjective*	chosen by chance, with no set order or pattern	by chance, mixed, unplanned		*In a random trial, half the patients were given the drug and half a placebo*	Journal
Rapprochement	*noun*	a renewal of friendly relations between countries after tension	making up, warming ties, reconciliation		*Trade talks signalled a cautious rapprochement between the old foes*	Journal
Ratification	*noun*	The official approval that makes a treaty or agreement legally binding	approval, sign-off, confirmation		*The trade pact awaits ratification by all twelve member parliaments*	Journal
Ratify	*verb*	to officially approve or confirm an agreement	approve, confirm, accept	reject, refuse, cancel, oppose, repeal, annul, veto	*Parliament is expected to ratify the trade treaty next month after long debate*	News·Y
Ratio	*noun*	a way of comparing two amounts by how many times one fits the other	proportion, balance, rate		*The study reported a ratio of three women to every two men in the workforce*	Journal
Recalcitrant	*adjective*	refusing to obey, stubborn	stubborn, defiant	obedient, willing, cooperative, helpful, agreeable, compliant, docile, amenable	*Recalcitrant states delayed the national reform*	News·S
Recede	*verb*	To move back, shrink, or become weaker over time	retreat, shrink, fade		*As inflation receded, central banks began cutting interest rates*	Journal
Recession	*noun*	a period when the economy shrinks and business slows for months	slowdown, slump, hard times		*The IMF warned that rising interest rates could push the eurozone into a mild recession*	Journal
Reconcile	*verb*	to make two opposing things agree / to make peace	settle, match	separate, divide, split, oppose, estrange, alienate	*It is hard to reconcile fast growth with low pollution*	News·S

WORD	POS	MEANING	SYNONYMS (easy words)	ANTONYMS (opposites)	EXAMPLE	SOURCE
Recoup	*verb*	to get back money or losses	recover, regain, get back	lose, waste, forfeit, squander, spend	*Airlines are struggling to recoup losses suffered during the lockdown*	News·Y
Recovery	*noun*	the return of the economy to health after a fall	rebound, comeback, healing		*A fragile recovery took hold as factory output rose for the third straight month*	Journal
Rectify	*verb*	to correct something that is wrong	correct, fix, repair	break, damage, harm, worsen, spoil, ruin	*The board promised to rectify the accounting errors flagged by auditors*	News·Y
Redistribution	*noun*	sharing wealth or resources more evenly, often through taxes and welfare	sharing out, spreading, reallocation		*The reform package leaned on redistribution, taxing high earners to fund services for the poor*	Journal
Redress	*noun/verb*	to correct or set right a wrong	fix, correct, make right	break, worsen, harm, damage, aggravate	*Citizens deserve a swift mechanism to redress complaints against officials*	News·Y
Reel	*verb*	to be badly shaken or struggling	suffer		*The region is reeling under a severe drought*	News·S
Regime	*noun*	a government in power, often one seen as harsh or unelected	government, rulers, ruling power		*The new sanctions target officials close to the ruling regime*	Journal
Reiterate	*verb*	to say again to make it clear	repeat		*The minister reiterated that no tax would be raised*	News·S
Remit	*noun*	The area of authority or the set of tasks a person or body is responsible for	duty, scope, job		*Climate policy falls outside the central bank's official remit*	Journal
Remittance	*noun*	money sent home by workers living abroad	money sent home, transfer		*Remittances from Gulf workers remain a vital source of foreign income for India*	Journal
Reparations	*noun*	money paid by a country to make up for war damage or harm	compensation, payback, damages		*The treaty required the defeated nation to pay heavy reparations*	Journal
Repatriate	*verb*	to send someone back to their own country	send home, return, bring back		*Aid agencies are working to repatriate refugees once the fighting ends*	Journal
Repercussion	*noun*	an indirect, often bad, result of an action	consequence, effect, result	cause, source, origin	*The sudden ban had serious repercussions for thousands of small traders*	News·Y
Replicate	*verb*	to repeat a study or test to check if the result is the same	repeat, copy, redo		*Other labs failed to replicate the original findings, raising doubts about the claim*	Journal
Reprehensible	*adjective*	very bad and deserving strong blame	shameful, wrong, blameworthy	good, fine, right, praiseworthy, admirable, commendable, blameless	*The court called the police inaction during the riots reprehensible*	News·Y
Repression	*noun*	the use of force or control to stop people's freedom or protest	crackdown, control, holding down		*Human-rights groups documented growing repression as the state silenced journalists and banned rallies*	Journal
Reprieve	*noun*	a temporary relief from trouble or punishment	relief, break, pause	punishment, penalty, sentence, condemnation	*The monsoon rains offered a brief reprieve from the crippling drought*	News·Y
Requisite	*adjective*	needed or required for a particular purpose	needed, required, must-have		*Many nurses left because hospitals lacked the requisite funding and staff*	Journal
Rescind	*verb*	to cancel or take back an order or decision	cancel, undo, withdraw	keep, allow, approve, support, uphold, enforce,	*Facing protests, the government was forced to rescind the controversial order*	News·Y

WORD	POS	MEANING	SYNONYMS (easy words)	ANTONYMS (opposites)	EXAMPLE	SOURCE
				reinstate, validate		
Resilience	*noun*	the ability to recover quickly after a shock or disaster	toughness, bounce-back, strength		*The IMF stressed building economic resilience so countries can withstand future climate shocks*	Journal
Resilient	*adjective*	able to recover quickly from problems	strong, tough	weak, fragile, delicate, frail, brittle, vulnerable	*The economy proved resilient despite global shocks*	News·S
Reticent	*adjective*	unwilling to speak much or share one's thoughts	quiet, shy, silent	talkative, open, frank, chatty, outspoken, forthcoming, communicative	*The government was reticent about the real cost of the bailout package*	News·Y
Rhetoric	*noun*	fancy speech meant to persuade (often empty)	big talk	action, silence, plainness, sincerity, simplicity	*Voters are tired of rhetoric and want real action*	News·S
Rife	*adjective*	very common, usually of something bad	widespread, common, everywhere	rare, scarce, uncommon, few, absent, infrequent	*Corruption is rife in the licensing offices, where bribes decide how fast files move*	News·Y
Robust	*adjective*	strong and reliable; holds true even when tested in different ways	strong, solid, sturdy		*The link between smoking and lung cancer is robust and has been confirmed in study after study*	Journal
S						
Salient	*adjective*	most important or most noticeable	key, main, standing out		*The minister summarised the salient points of the agreement before the press conference began*	Journal
Sample	*noun*	a small group chosen to stand for a much larger group	group, selection, portion		*The survey used a sample of 2,000 adults to represent the whole country*	Journal
Sanctimonious	*adjective*	acting as if you are morally better than others in a fake way	preachy, self-righteous, smug	humble, modest, sincere, honest, down-to-earth, unpretentious	*The editorial mocked the sanctimonious tone of leaders who themselves flouted the rules*	News·Y
Sanction	*noun/verb*	(1) official punishment/ban (2) to approve	ban / approve		*Western countries imposed sanctions on the regime*	News·S
Sanctioned	*adjective*	hit with official penalties (or, confusingly, officially approved)	penalised, punished, banned		*The sanctioned officials are barred from travelling to Europe*	Journal
Sangfroid	*noun*	calmness under pressure	composure, cool head		*She handled the crisis with remarkable sangfroid*	News·S
Sanguine	*adjective*	hopeful and positive even in difficulty	optimistic, hopeful	sad, hopeless, gloomy, pessimistic, despairing, melancholy	*Economists remain sanguine about next year's growth*	News·S
Scarce	*adjective*	very little available; in short supply	rare, few, limited	plenty, enough, common, ample, abundant, plentiful	*Jobs have become scarce for young graduates in small towns*	News·Y
Schadenfreude	*noun*	pleasure at another person's trouble	gloating		*There was open schadenfreude when the rival firm collapsed*	News·S
Scrutiny	*noun*	careful and close examination	checking, inspection	ignoring, neglect, oversight, inattention, carelessness	*The deal is under scrutiny by the tax department*	News·S
Secession	*noun*	The act of a region formally breaking away from a country to form its own	breakaway, split, separation		*The northern province's vote for secession alarmed neighbouring states*	Journal

WORD	POS	MEANING	SYNONYMS (easy words)	ANTONYMS (opposites)	EXAMPLE	SOURCE
Setback	*noun*	a problem that delays or stops progress	delay, problem, blow	progress, advance, gain, boost, breakthrough	*The project suffered a major setback after the central funds were withheld*	News·Y
Significant	*adjective*	large or important enough to matter, especially in results	important, large, notable		*The drop in infections was statistically significant, the Lancet study reported*	Journal
Slam	*verb*	to criticise strongly	attack, blame		*The opposition slammed the budget for ignoring farmers*	News·S
Slump	*noun/verb*	a big fall or weak period	drop, fall		*The economy is facing a slump as factories cut production*	News·S
Soar	*verb*	to rise quickly and high	jump, climb		*Vegetable prices soared after heavy rains*	News·S
Sovereign	*adjective*	belonging to a national government (often about debt)	national, state, government		*Investors grew nervous as Greece's sovereign debt climbed toward unsustainable levels*	Journal
Sovereignty	*noun*	a country's full power to rule itself without outside control	independence, self-rule, control		*Beijing insists that any foreign comment on the islands is an attack on its sovereignty*	Journal
Spark	*verb*	to cause or start (usually trouble)	trigger, cause		*The remark sparked protests across the state*	News·S
Specious	*adjective*	looks correct but is actually false	misleading	true, honest, genuine, valid, sound, sincere	*The argument was specious and fell apart under questioning*	News·S
Speculative	*adjective*	based on guessing, not on solid proof	guessing, uncertain, unproven		*Such estimates remain highly speculative until field data become available*	Journal
Sporadic	*adjective*	happening now and then, not regularly	occasional, scattered, irregular	regular, constant, steady, frequent, continuous, incessant	*Sporadic protests broke out in several districts over the fuel price hike*	News·Y
Spurious	*adjective*	fake, not genuine	false, fake		*The market was flooded with spurious medicines*	News·S
Stagnation	*noun*	a long period with no economic growth or improvement	standstill, no growth, stuck state		*Years of stagnation left the country's wages flat while neighbours surged ahead*	Journal
Stakeholder	*noun*	a person or group affected by or interested in a decision	player, party, group involved		*The report urged governments to consult all stakeholders, from farmers to investors, before approving the dam*	Journal
Stalemate	*noun*	A situation where neither side can win or move forward; a deadlock	deadlock, standoff, tie		*Peace talks collapsed into a stalemate, with neither side willing to budge*	Journal
Stall	*verb*	to stop or delay something on purpose or by problem	delay, stop, hold up	start, continue, advance, hasten, accelerate, proceed	*The talks stalled after both sides refused to soften their demands*	News·Y
status quo	*noun*	the current situation; the way things are now	the current state, things as they are		*Voters frustrated with the status quo backed the new party*	Journal
Staunch	*adjective*	very loyal and firm in support	loyal, firm, strong	disloyal, weak, unreliable, wavering, half-hearted, faithless, fickle	*He remained a staunch defender of press freedom throughout his career*	News·Y
Stem	*verb*	to stop or slow down something bad from spreading	stop, check, control	spread, allow, encourage, release, unleash	*The new rules aim to stem the flow of black money in the market*	News·Y

WORD	POS	MEANING	SYNONYMS (easy words)	ANTONYMS (opposites)	EXAMPLE	SOURCE
Stifle	*verb*	to stop something from developing or being expressed	block, smother, hold back	free, allow, release, encourage, promote, foster	*Harsh defamation laws can stifle free speech and honest reporting*	News·Y
Stimulus	*noun*	government money or action used to wake up a slow economy	boost, push, support package		*Washington unveiled a $2 trillion stimulus to revive demand during the downturn*	Journal
Stopgap	*noun/adjective*	a temporary fix used until a proper solution is found	temporary fix, makeshift, quick patch	permanent, lasting, durable, long-term, permanent solution	*Critics dismissed the cash handout as a stopgap that ignored the deeper crisis of rural unemployment*	News·Y
Stringent	*adjective*	very strict	strict, tough		*Stringent safety norms were introduced after the accident*	News·S
Stymie	*verb*	to block or stop someone from doing something	block, stop, hold back	help, allow, assist, aid, support, advance, facilitate	*Poor coordination between ministries continues to stymie the clean-energy programme*	News·Y
Subjugate	*verb*	To bring a people or country under harsh control by force	conquer, dominate, enslave		*The empire subjugated the coastal tribes and seized their land*	Journal
Subprime	*adjective*	describing loans to borrowers with poor credit and high risk	high-risk, low-quality, shaky		*The 2008 crash was triggered by defaults on subprime mortgages across America*	Journal
Subsidy	*noun*	money the government gives to lower a cost	financial help		*Farmers receive a subsidy on fertilisers*	News·S
Substantial	*adjective*	large in size or amount; clearly important	big, large, sizeable		*The report called for a substantial increase in funding for rural clinics*	Journal
Substantiate	*verb*	to prove with evidence; to back up a claim	prove, support, back up		*The newspaper could not substantiate the allegations and issued a public correction*	Journal
Subvert	*verb*	to secretly weaken or destroy a system or authority	weaken, damage, overthrow	support, help, strengthen, uphold, defend, sustain	*The court warned that such tactics could subvert the independence of institutions*	News·Y
Suffrage	*noun*	the right to vote in political elections	the vote, voting right		*The suffrage movement fought for decades before women were granted equal voting rights*	Journal
Surge	*noun/verb*	a sudden strong increase	rush, rise, jump	fall, drop, decline, decrease, dip, plunge	*The festival season saw a sharp surge in online shopping across cities*	News·Y
Surmise	*verb*	to guess something from the small clues you have	guess, suppose, figure out		*From the wear patterns, archaeologists surmise the tools were used for grinding grain*	Journal
Surplus	*noun*	the extra amount left when income is more than spending	extra, leftover, spare amount		*Germany ran a large trade surplus, exporting far more than it bought from abroad*	Journal
Survey	*noun*	a set of questions asked to many people to gather information	poll, study, questionnaire		*A nationwide survey found that two in three workers want to keep working from home*	Journal
Sustainable	*adjective*	able to continue for a long time without using up resources or harming the planet	lasting, green, long-term		*The UN's Sustainable Development Goals aim to end poverty by 2030 without damaging the environment*	Journal
Sustained	*adjective*	kept going over time without stopping	steady, ongoing, continued		*Sustained investment lifted millions out of poverty*	Journal
Sycophant	*noun*	a person who flatters powerful people to gain favour	flatterer, yes-man	critic, opponent, rebel	*The leader was surrounded by sycophants, not advisers*	News·S

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Synthesis	*noun*	combining parts into a whole	blend, mixture, combination		*The review offers a synthesis of fifty separate studies*	Journal
Systematic	*adjective*	done in an organized, methodical way	orderly, planned, careful		*A systematic review examined every published trial on the drug*	Journal
Systemic	*adjective*	affecting a whole system, not just one part; built into how things work	system-wide, deep-rooted, whole-system		*The crash exposed systemic weaknesses in the global banking system*	Journal
T						
Tacit	*adjective*	understood without being said openly	unspoken, silent, implied		*By taking no action, the regulator gave tacit approval to the merger*	Journal
Tackle	*verb*	to deal with a difficult problem	handle, face, deal with	avoid, ignore, dodge, evade, sidestep	*The state has launched a fresh drive to tackle child malnutrition*	News·Y
Tangible	*adjective*	real and clear enough to be seen or felt	real, clear, solid	unreal, hidden, vague, abstract, imaginary, intangible	*Voters now want tangible results, not just promises on paper*	News·Y
Tantamount	*adjective*	equal to; the same as (something bad)	equal to, the same as, as good as	different, unequal, unlike, opposite	*Silence from the leadership, the writer said, is tantamount to approving the violence*	News·Y
Tariff	*noun*	a tax placed on goods coming into a country	import tax, duty, charge		*Washington imposed steep tariffs on imported steel, angering its trading partners*	Journal
Tenable	*adjective*	able to be defended or believed	defensible, reasonable, sound		*Critics argued the theory was no longer tenable*	Journal
Tenet	*noun*	a main belief or principle that a group or theory is built on	core belief, principle, key idea		*Free trade is a central tenet of the institution's economic philosophy*	Journal
Tentative	*adjective*	not final or sure; just a first try that may change	unsure, temporary, not fixed		*Researchers offered only a tentative explanation, warning that more data was needed before any firm conclusion*	Journal
Tenuous	*adjective*	weak, not strong or certain	weak, thin	strong, solid, firm, thick, substantial, convincing	*The evidence linking the two events is tenuous*	News·S
Tepid	*adjective*	showing little interest or warmth; lukewarm	weak, dull, cool	warm, eager, keen, excited, enthusiastic, passionate, hearty	*The market gave a tepid response to the government's new reform package*	News·Y
Thereby	*adverb*	by that means; as a result of that	so, thus, in that way		*The reforms cut paperwork and thereby freed doctors to see more patients*	Journal
Threshold	*noun*	the point at which something starts to happen or change	limit, starting point, boundary		*Temperatures are nearing the threshold beyond which coral reefs cannot recover*	Journal
Thrive	*verb*	to grow well and become very successful	grow, succeed, do well	fail, die, suffer, decline, wither, languish	*Small businesses began to thrive once the local market reopened*	News·Y
Thus	*adverb*	therefore; in this way; as a result	so, therefore, in this way		*Rainfall was poor; the harvest, thus, fell short of targets*	Journal

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Thwart	*verb*	to stop someone's plan from succeeding	block, stop, foil	help, allow, support, assist, aid, encourage, promote, facilitate	*Alert security forces thwarted a major attack planned during the rally*	News·Y
Tirade	*noun*	a long, angry speech of criticism or blame	rant, outburst, attack	praise, compliment, tribute, commendation	*The minister's tirade against the press did little to address the real concerns raised in the report*	News·Y
Trajectory	*noun*	the path or direction something follows over time	path, course, direction		*The country is on a trajectory to miss its emissions targets by 2030*	Journal
Transition	*noun*	the process of changing from one state to another	shift, change, switch		*The IMF backed a fair transition for workers as the country moves away from coal*	Journal
Travesty	*noun*	a bad and unfair copy or example that insults the real thing	mockery, joke, insult	true copy, faithful version, accurate representation	*Denying the accused a lawyer was called a travesty of justice by the high court*	News·Y
Trenchant	*adjective*	sharp, clear, and forceful (about words or criticism)	sharp, strong, biting	weak, vague, dull, gentle, mild, unclear	*In a trenchant editorial, the paper exposed the loopholes in the new labour law*	News·Y
Trend	*noun*	the general direction in which something is changing over time	pattern, direction, drift		*The report highlights a worrying upward trend in youth unemployment across the region*	Journal
Truculent	*adjective*	aggressive and eager to argue	hostile, fighting		*The minister gave a truculent reply to the press*	News·S
Truncate	*verb*	to cut short or shorten by removing the end	cut, shorten, trim	extend, lengthen, stretch, prolong, expand	*The Speaker truncated the debate, denying the Opposition time to raise pressing questions*	News·Y
Tumultuous	*adjective*	Full of noise, disorder, or violent change; very unsettled	stormy, chaotic, wild		*The nation endured a tumultuous decade of coups and uprisings*	Journal
Turbulent	*adjective*	full of trouble, sudden change, or conflict	stormy, restless, unsettled	calm, peaceful, quiet, smooth, steady, tranquil	*The state passed through a turbulent decade of unrest before peace talks finally began*	News·Y
Turmoil	*noun*	a state of great confusion and trouble	chaos, trouble, unrest	peace, calm, order, quiet, stability, tranquillity	*The sudden policy change threw the stock market into turmoil*	News·Y
Tussle	*noun*	a struggle or fight, usually for power or control	fight, struggle, clash	peace, agreement, harmony, truce, calm	*The tussle between the Centre and the states over fund sharing has delayed many projects*	News·Y
U						
Ubiquitous	*adjective*	found everywhere	everywhere, common	rare, scarce, uncommon, absent, limited	*Smartphones have become ubiquitous in rural India*	News·S
Unbridled	*adjective*	not controlled or held back; without limits	unchecked, wild, free	controlled, limited, restrained, checked, curbed	*Unbridled spending before the elections has pushed the state deep into debt*	News·Y
Uncertainty	*noun*	the range of doubt in a measurement or result	doubt, unsureness, error		*The forecast carried a high degree of uncertainty about future warming*	Journal
Underlying	*adjective*	hidden beneath the surface; the real cause behind something	hidden, basic, root		*The study aimed to find the underlying cause of the recurring infections*	Journal
Undermine	*verb*	to weaken slowly	weaken	strengthen, help, support, boost, reinforce, bolster, fortify	*Fake news can undermine democracy*	News·S

WORD	POS	MEANING	SYNONYMS (easy words)	ANTONYMS (opposites)	EXAMPLE	SOURCE
Underpin	*verb*	to support or form the base of something	support, back, hold up		*Strong institutions and the rule of law underpin long-term economic growth, the World Bank study argues*	Journal
Underscore	*verb*	to give strong emphasis to something	stress, highlight, emphasise		*The findings underscore the urgent need for clean water in the region*	Journal
Unequivocal	*adjective*	completely clear, leaving no doubt	clear, plain, certain		*The panel issued an unequivocal warning that emissions must fall this decade*	Journal
Unfettered	*adjective*	free, with no rules or chains holding it back	free, unrestricted, loose	tied, bound, chained, restricted, confined, restrained	*The court ruled that free speech cannot be unfettered when it incites violence*	News·Y
Unilateral	*adjective*	done by one country alone, without agreement from others	one-sided, alone, solo		*Critics called the unilateral airstrikes a dangerous break from allied policy*	Journal
Unprecedented	*adjective*	never happened before	new, first-ever	normal, common, usual, ordinary, routine, customary	*The country faced an unprecedented heatwave this summer*	News·S
Unravel	*verb*	to slowly fall apart or come undone	fall apart, unwind, collapse	join, fix, tangle, weave, mend, knit	*The coalition began to unravel as smaller parties withdrew their support one by one*	News·Y
Untenable	*adjective*	not able to be defended or continued	weak, indefensible, not holding up	strong, sound, solid, defensible, justifiable, tenable	*The minister's claim became untenable once the official data was made public*	News·Y
Upheaval	*noun*	a big, sudden change that causes trouble or disorder	disorder, upset, disturbance	calm, peace, order, stability, quiet	*The farm laws triggered a social upheaval that lasted for over a year*	News·Y
Urge	*verb*	to strongly request	push, ask		*Doctors urge people to get vaccinated before winter*	News·S
Usurp	*verb*	to take power or a position by force, without the right	seize, grab, take over	give, surrender, yield, relinquish, hand over	*Critics warned that the ordinance allowed the executive to usurp powers meant for Parliament*	News·Y
V						
Vacillate	*verb*	to keep changing your mind; be unable to decide	waver, hesitate, doubt	decide, resolve, settle, commit, persist	*The committee vacillated for months, leaving the disaster victims without any relief*	News·Y
Variable	*noun*	a factor that can change and is measured in a study	factor, element, condition		*Income, age, and diet were the main variables the scientists tracked over ten years*	Journal
Vehement	*adjective*	showing very strong, forceful feeling	strong, fierce, intense	calm, mild, gentle, weak, indifferent, apathetic	*The Opposition voiced vehement objection to the bill being passed without discussion*	News·Y
Venal	*adjective*	ready to do wrong for money; corrupt	corrupt, greedy, bribable	honest, fair, clean, ethical, principled, incorruptible, upright	*A venal officialdom turns even basic public services into a marketplace for bribes*	News·Y
Veneer	*noun*	a thin, attractive surface that hides what is really underneath	cover, mask, surface	core, reality, substance, truth, interior	*Behind the veneer of development lay villages still without clean drinking water*	News·Y
Vex	*verb*	to annoy, worry, or trouble someone	annoy, bother, trouble	please, calm, comfort, soothe, delight, reassure	*The unresolved border dispute continues to vex relations between the two neighbours*	News·Y

WORD	POS	MEANING	SYNONYMS (easy words)	ANTONYMS (opposites)	EXAMPLE	SOURCE
Viable	*adjective*	able to work or succeed practically	workable, possible, practical	hopeless, useless, unworkable, impractical, unrealistic, nonviable	*Solar power is now a viable alternative for many rural households*	News·Y
vice versa	*phrase*	the other way around; the reverse is also true	the other way round, in reverse		*Exports affect the currency, and vice versa*	Journal
Vicissitude	*noun*	a change of fortune, ups and downs	ups and downs		*The industry has survived many vicissitudes*	News·S
Vie	*verb*	to compete strongly with others for something	compete, fight, contest	share, cooperate, agree, yield, give up	*Several states are now vying for the same factory investment with rival tax offers*	News·Y
Vilify	*verb*	to say very bad and unfair things about someone	insult, run down, blacken	praise, honour, compliment, glorify, commend, extol, laud	*The campaign tried to vilify the whistle-blower instead of answering her charges*	News·Y
Vindicate	*verb*	to prove someone was right after doubt	prove right	blame, accuse, convict, condemn, incriminate	*The findings vindicated the scientist's earlier warning*	News·S
vis-a-vis	*preposition*	in relation to; compared with; regarding	compared with, about, towards		*The rupee weakened vis-a-vis the dollar over the quarter*	Journal
Vitriolic	*adjective*	full of bitter, cruel and harsh criticism	bitter, harsh, cruel	kind, gentle, sweet, friendly, pleasant, complimentary, benign	*The campaign turned vitriolic, with leaders trading personal insults daily*	News·Y
Vituperative	*adjective*	full of bitter, abusive criticism	harshly critical		*The campaign turned vituperative in its final week*	News·S
Vociferous	*adjective*	loud and strong in expressing opinions	loud, noisy, outspoken	quiet, silent, soft, calm, reserved, subdued	*Vociferous protests outside Parliament forced the government to review the controversial clause*	News·Y
Volatile	*adjective*	changing suddenly and unpredictably	unstable, shaky		*Oil prices remain volatile due to the conflict*	News·S
Volatility	*noun*	how quickly and sharply prices move up and down	wild swings, ups and downs, instability		*Market volatility spiked as traders reacted to conflicting inflation data*	Journal
Voracious	*adjective*	wanting a very large amount; very greedy or eager	greedy, hungry, eager	full, satisfied, uninterested, indifferent, moderate	*The city's voracious demand for water has drained the surrounding rivers dry*	News·Y
Vow	*verb/noun*	to promise firmly	promise		*The minister vowed to complete the project by next year*	News·S
Vulnerable	*adjective*	easily harmed or at risk	at risk, exposed, weak		*The report warned that the poorest nations remain the most vulnerable to extreme weather*	Journal
W						
Wane	*verb*	to slowly become weaker or less	fade, weaken, drop	grow, rise, increase, strengthen, expand, wax	*Public interest in the campaign began to wane after the elections ended*	News·Y
Wanton	*adjective*	done with no good reason; cruel and careless	reckless, needless, cruel	careful, kind, justified, responsible, restrained, deliberate	*The report condemned the wanton destruction of forests for short-term profit*	News·Y
Warrant	*verb*	to be a good enough reason for something; to deserve	deserve, justify, need	forbid, stop, refuse, ban, contradict, disallow, negate	*The scale of the tragedy warrants an independent inquiry, not a quiet internal review*	News·Y

WORD	POS	MEANING	SYNONYMS (easy words)	ANTONYMS (opposites)	EXAMPLE	SOURCE
Warranted	*adjective*	justified by the facts; reasonable	justified, fair, deserved		*Given the rising case numbers, stricter travel rules now appear warranted*	Journal
Watershed	*noun*	a major turning point	turning point		*The verdict was a watershed moment for women's rights*	News·S
Wayward	*adjective*	hard to control; doing wrong or unexpected things	unruly, stubborn, wild	obedient, good, well-behaved, reliable, manageable, dutiful, compliant, docile	*The party struggled to rein in its wayward members who openly defied the leadership*	News·Y
Whereby	*adverb*	by which; through which (a method or arrangement)	by which, through which		*The treaty created a system whereby disputes go to a neutral panel*	Journal
Whittle	*verb*	to slowly reduce something little by little	cut down, reduce, shrink	increase, add, grow, build, expand, enlarge, augment	*Successive delays have whittled down public trust in the housing scheme*	News·Y
Woo	*verb*	to try to attract or win support	attract		*Both parties are trying to woo young voters*	News·S
Word	*part of speech*	simple meaning	synonym	a thesaurus list, from simple words you know to higher ones	*Newspaper-style sentence*	News·S
X						
Xenophobia	*noun*	strong fear or dislike of people from other countries	fear of foreigners, prejudice, hatred	welcome, acceptance, openness, tolerance, hospitality, xenophilia	*Editorials warned that rising xenophobia could harm the nation's image as a welcoming land*	News·Y
Y						
Yardstick	*noun*	a standard used to judge or measure something	measure, standard, test	guess, estimate	*Per capita income alone is a poor yardstick for measuring a country's real progress*	News·Y
Yield	*verb*	to produce or give a result or amount	produce, give, return		*The new farming method yielded twenty percent more grain per acre*	Journal
Yoke	*noun*	a heavy burden or harsh control that holds people down	burden, control, weight	freedom, liberty, release, independence, liberation	*Small traders say the yoke of complex tax rules is crushing their daily business*	News·Y
Z						
Zealous	*adjective*	showing great energy and strong eagerness for a cause	eager, keen, passionate	lazy, cool, careless, uninterested, indifferent, apathetic, half-hearted	*Overly zealous enforcement of the rules has frightened away honest small investors*	News·Y
Zenith	*noun*	the highest or most successful point	peak, top, height	bottom, low point, lowest, depth, nadir	*The movement reached its zenith when millions joined the march across the country*	News·Y

B · Idioms & Phrases (75)

IDIOM / PHRASE	MEANING	EXAMPLE / USAGE
A bitter pill to swallow	an unpleasant fact or decision one must accept	*The tax hike was a bitter pill for the middle class to swallow*

IDIOM / PHRASE	MEANING	EXAMPLE / USAGE
A blessing in disguise	Something good that seemed bad at first	
A canary in the coal mine	an early warning sign of a bigger danger	*Melting glaciers are a canary in the coal mine for the whole region*
A double-edged sword	something with both clear benefits and serious risks	*Social media is a double-edged sword for democracy*
A drop in the ocean	a tiny, almost meaningless amount compared to what is needed	*The pledged funds are a drop in the ocean against the climate bill*
A flash in the pan	a sudden success that is not repeated. (From old flintlock guns; the image is now lost on most readers.)	*Many feared the start-up would be just a flash in the pan*
A flashpoint	a place or issue likely to erupt into conflict	*The disputed border remains a dangerous flashpoint*
A level playing field	fair conditions where everyone competes equally	*Small traders demanded a level playing field against large online platforms*
A nine days' wonder	something that causes excitement very briefly, then is forgotten	*The scandal proved a nine days' wonder*
A piece of cake	Something very easy	
A Pyrrhic victory	a win that costs so much it feels like a defeat. (Still seen in editorials — see [Newspaper Vocabulary] (10_Newspaper_Vocabulary.md).)	*Winning the case but losing the firm was a Pyrrhic victory*
A race to the bottom	competition that lowers standards, wages or prices harmfully	*Cheap imports triggered a race to the bottom on quality*
A soft landing	slowing an overheated economy without causing a recession	*The central bank is still hoping to engineer a soft landing*
A storm in a teacup	a lot of fuss about something trivial	*Officials dismissed the row as a storm in a teacup*
A war of words	a heated public exchange of hostile statements	*The summit collapsed into a war of words*
An echo chamber	a space where people only hear views that match their own	*Algorithms trap users in political echo chambers*
An optics problem / bad optics	something that simply looks bad to the public, regardless of facts	*The lavish event during a drought was, at the very least, bad optics*
At sixes and sevens	in a state of total confusion and disorder	*The committee was at sixes and sevens over the agenda*
Bang for the buck	good value for the money spent	*Voters want more bang for the buck from public spending*
Boom and bust	a cycle of rapid growth followed by sharp collapse	*The sector is notorious for its boom-and-bust nature*
Break the ice	To start a conversation in a social setting	
Cold enough to freeze the balls off a brass monkey	extremely cold. (Old naval slang; survives mostly as trivia.)	*It was cold enough to freeze the balls off a brass monkey on the platform*
Green shoots	early signs of recovery or growth	*Economists spotted green shoots in the latest manufacturing data*
Hit the books	To study hard	
Hugger-mugger	done in secret and in a confused, disorderly way	*The deal was arranged in hugger-mugger fashion*
Let the cat out of the bag	To reveal a secret	
Once in a blue moon	Very rarely	
The genie is out of the bottle	a powerful change has been released and cannot be undone	*With generative AI, the genie is out of the bottle*
To add fuel to the fire	To make a situation worse	
To be hoist with one's own petard	to be harmed by the very trap you set for others. (From Shakespeare; almost never used today.)	*The schemer was hoist with his own petard when the plan backfired*

IDIOM / PHRASE	MEANING	EXAMPLE / USAGE
To be in hot water	To be in trouble	
To be in one's cups	to be drunk. (Beautifully old-fashioned.)	*The witness admitted he had been in his cups that night*
To beat around the bush	To avoid the main point	
To bite the bullet	To endure a painful situation bravely	
To burn the midnight oil	To work or study late into the night	
To bury the hatchet	To make peace and end a conflict	
To carry coals to Newcastle	to take something to a place that already has plenty of it; a pointless act	*Selling sand in the desert is carrying coals to Newcastle*
To corner the market	to gain control over the supply of something	*A few firms have cornered the market in rare-earth minerals*
To cost an arm and a leg	To be extremely expensive	
To curry favour	to win approval through flattery and pleasing acts. (Still occasionally seen, but now rare.)	*He spent years currying favour with the board*
To cut the Gordian knot	to solve a very difficult problem with one bold, decisive action	*The new policy cut the Gordian knot of land disputes*
To dog-whistle	to send a hidden message to a particular group while sounding innocent to others	*Analysts said the speech contained a clear dog-whistle to the base*
To double down	to commit even more strongly to a position, despite criticism	*The minister doubled down on the controversial remarks the next day*
To draw a red line	to set a limit that must not be crossed	*The leader drew a red line over the territory*
To eat humble pie	to admit you were wrong and apologise. (Survives, but "humble pie" itself — once "umble pie," made of offal — is now opaque to most.)	*After the data was checked, the agency had to eat humble pie*
To extend an olive branch	to make an offer of peace or reconciliation	*The new government extended an olive branch to the rebels*
To gild the lily	to add useless decoration to something already beautiful; to over-improve	*Adding music to that perfect speech would only gild the lily. (Faded because the shorter "overdo it" replaced it.)*
To go the whole hog	to do something completely, holding nothing back	*If we reform, let's go the whole hog*
To go viral	to spread very rapidly online	*The clip went viral within hours of being posted*
To kick the can down the road	to delay dealing with a problem instead of solving it now	*Critics say the budget merely kicks the can down the road on pension reform*
To make a clean breast of it	to confess everything fully	*He finally made a clean breast of the whole affair*
To move fast and break things	to innovate aggressively without worrying about damage (often used critically now)	*Regulators are tired of the "move fast and break things" culture*
To move the goalposts	to unfairly change the rules or targets after things have started	*Opposition leaders accused the government of moving the goalposts on the deadline*
To pass the buck	to shift responsibility onto someone else	*Departments kept passing the buck over who approved the project*
To pay lip service	to express support in words only, without real action	*Governments pay lip service to green goals but keep funding coal*
To pull someone's leg	To tease or joke with someone	
To pull the plug	to suddenly stop or shut down a project/service	*The company pulled the plug on the loss-making app*

IDIOM / PHRASE	MEANING	EXAMPLE / USAGE
To rattle the sabre / sabre-rattling	to make aggressive threats of force	*The drills were dismissed as mere sabre-rattling*
To read the room	to sense the mood of a group and respond appropriately	*The party failed to read the room on rising unemployment*
To rest on one's laurels	to rely on past success and stop trying	*The champions cannot afford to rest on their laurels*
To set one's cap at someone	to try to win someone's romantic interest. (Sounds quaint now; rarely used.)	*She was accused of setting her cap at the young heir*
To steal a march on someone	to gain an advantage secretly before a rival can react	*The firm stole a march on competitors with an early launch*
To steal someone's thunder	To take credit for another's work or idea	
To throw down the gauntlet	to issue a bold challenge	*The challenger threw down the gauntlet to the champion*
To throw in the towel	To give up or surrender	
To throw under the bus	to betray or blame someone to save yourself	*The junior officer was thrown under the bus when the scheme failed*
To tighten the belt / belt-tightening	to cut spending in hard times	*Households are tightening their belts as inflation bites*
To turn a blind eye	To ignore something deliberately	
To turn the tide	to reverse the direction of events	*Renewables alone may not turn the tide on emissions*
To walk a tightrope	to manage a very delicate, risky balance	*The country is walking a tightrope between the two superpowers*
To weather extremes	to endure severe conditions (often literal and figurative in climate copy)	*Coastal cities must now weather extremes they never planned for*
To weather the storm	to survive a difficult period	*Exporters weathered the storm despite the global slowdown*
To win one's spurs	to prove oneself and earn respect for the first time	*The young lawyer won her spurs in that landmark case*
Too big to fail	so large that its collapse would harm the whole system, so it gets rescued	*The bailout revived the old "too big to fail" debate*
Under the weather	Feeling unwell	